SAINT MICHAEL COLLEGE OF CARAGA

CHALLENGES AND ADAPTATION OF TEACHERS TEACHING NON-SPECIALIZED SUBJECTS

A Thesis Presented To
The Faculty of
College of Teacher Education

In Partial Requirements for the Degree
BACHELOR OF TECHNICAL VOCATIONAL TEACHER EDUCATION

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MARCH 2026

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CHAPTER 1

THE PROBLEM AND ITS SCOPE

1.1 Background of the study

The teaching profession requires a deep sense of passion, love, and dedication. It is defined by its high level of complexity and dynamism and demands both subject-matter competence and pedagogical skills. It is universally accepted that teaching is among the noblest professions. Gaso (2025), Leonin (2024), and Obias et al., (2025), assert that the multifaceted nature of teaching makes it one of the most esteemed careers, as the initial step in preparing students for any profession is rooted in education. Moreover, teachers' flexibility and adaptability enable them to effectively perform these multifaceted roles. With this, teachers are often described as "jacks of all trades"—individuals capable of carrying out diverse tasks and responsibilities with competence.

Teachers' ability to improve the quality and effectiveness of teaching depends on the integration of thoughtful planning, the integration of flexible teaching methods, and continuous reflection on their classroom experiences (Dursun et al., 2025). These abilities pave the way towards achieving Sustainable Development Goal 4 (SDG 4): Quality Education, which aims to ensure "inclusive and equitable quality education and promote lifelong learning opportunities for all." UNESCO (2024) emphasizes that high-quality teacher education and continuous specialized training are fundamental in preparing teachers to deliver quality education that is holistic, transformative, inclusive, effective, and relevant. Ideally, teachers are assigned based on their specialized subjects, qualifications, and professional training. However, there are instances when they are required to teach beyond the area of their expertise. Such teachers are commonly referred to as teachers teaching non-specialized subjects (Buenacosa & Petallo, 2022).

Teaching non-specialized subjects is a prevalent issue worldwide, which significantly affects the overall quality of education (Fullido, 2025). This phenomenon can be linked to various causes; studies found

shortages of subject specialists, unequal subject load distribution, and policy gaps (Javines & Azarias,2024) as the primary causes. Rodriguez (2025) found that personal dedication and a desire to help others were among the most important factors affecting the prevalence of out-of-field education. Other reasons include a lack of teachers in specific subjects, insufficient qualified applicants, administrative decisions, and a lack of interest in the subject one is assigned (Hobbs & Porsch, 2021).

In the Philippines, the EDCOM 2 report released in January 2025 states that 62% of high school teachers teach subjects outside of their college major, highlighting a significant misalignment between teacher training programs and school-level needs. This report underscores the prevalence of teaching non-specialized subject phenomenon in the country, which poses major challenges that significantly affect both teachers' teaching confidence and effectiveness and students' learning outcomes.

Teachers teaching non-specialized subjects face a wide range of challenges that can make them question their teaching competence and affect their overall effectiveness. Studies indicate that these teachers often struggle with content mastery, requiring additional time to study and understand topics beyond their areas of specialization (Baras & Gillo, 2024; Roxas, 2022). Baras & Gillo (2024) and Bugwak (2021) reported that teachers teaching non-specialized subjects frequently experience low self-esteem and difficulty in maintaining classroom authority. Moreover, Roxas (2022) found that lesson planning and activity preparation are often time-consuming and stressful, as these teachers must exert additional effort to design appropriate materials and strategies for unfamiliar subjects. Choosing and applying effective teaching methods also pose a recurring challenge, as many teachers teaching non-specialized subjects are uncertain about the most suitable approaches to promote student understanding (Arendain & Limpot, 2022; Bugwak, 2021). In addition, Yumang (2021) highlighted that teachers teaching non-specialized subjects often struggle to respond confidently and accurately to students' inquiries.

On the other hand, studies have discovered that this phenomenon significantly influences students' academic performance. Students in classes handled by teachers teaching non-specialized subjects are more likely to experience surface learning, achieve lower test scores, occasionally lose self-confidence (Nakar & Du Plessis, 2023), and demonstrate lower academic performance compared to those taught by teachers within their areas of specialization (Branzuela et al., 2023).

Despite these challenges, several studies have also revealed that teachers teaching non-specialized subjects employ various adaptations to manage the demands of teaching subjects outside their expertise. Baras and Gillo (2024) emphasize that careful lesson planning is one of the most common adaptations, as teachers prepare lessons and materials ahead of time to enhance their understanding before entering the classroom. Collaboration through sharing, mentoring, and teamwork is also a key adaptive strategy (Baras & Gillo, 2024); Bugwak, 2021). Furthermore, Castro et al. (2023) highlighted that professional training plays a vital role in helping teachers build competence and confidence in teaching general courses.

Additionally, the United Nations Secretary-General's High-Level Panel on the Teaching Profession (2024) noted the growing global shortage of qualified teachers—one of the major causes of teaching non-specialized subjects. In response, the UN has proposed a set of strategies and recommendations aimed at revitalizing the teaching profession, including equitable teacher deployment, strengthened teacher education programs, and continuous professional development to equip educators with specialized competencies aligned with their assigned subjects.

Given the continued prevalence of the teaching non-specialized subject phenomenon and its impact on the overall quality of education, it is imperative to examine the specific challenges that teachers encounter when assigned to teach subjects beyond their field of specialization, as well as the adaptation

they employ to address these challenges. Hence, this study aims to investigate the difficulties face by non-specialized teachers and to explore the adaptation to effectively manage their teaching responsibilities.

In addition, the study seeks to determine whether there are significant differences in the challenges and adaptation of teachers teaching non-specialized subjects when grouped according to their profile variables, namely sex, qualification, years of teaching, area of specialization, subjects handled out of specialization, and school location. It also aims to examine whether a significant relationship exists between the challenges encountered and the adaptation employed by the respondents.

To achieve these objectives, the study will employ a descriptive–comparative and correlational quantitative research design to provide comprehensive insights into the nature, extent, and interrelationships among the identified variables. Descriptive statistics will be used to summarize the teachers' demographic profiles and responses, while inferential statistics—specifically the t-test and Analysis of Variance (ANOVA)—will determine significant differences in the challenges and adaptation across teacher profiles. Moreover, the Pearson correlation coefficient will be utilized to examine the significant relationship between the challenges encountered and the adaptation employed.

This study is significant as it addresses the growing prevalence of teaching non-specialized subject and its impact on teacher competence, instructional quality, and student learning outcomes, offering valuable insights into one of the most critical challenges in today's education system. It provides teachers with a deeper understanding of the difficulties they encounter such as limited content mastery, increased preparation time, low confidence, and challenges in selecting appropriate teaching strategies while identifying effective adaptation like careful lesson planning, collaboration, peer mentoring, and participation in professional training. For school administrators and educational leaders, the study offers evidence-based information that can guide better teacher deployment practices, targeted support programs, and more strategic staffing, especially in light of the EDCOM 2 (2025) report that 62% of

Philippine high school teachers teach outside their specialization. Teacher Education Institutions may use the findings to strengthen and align their curricula with school demands by integrating interdisciplinary content and flexible pedagogical training, while policymakers may draw from the results to refine policies addressing teacher shortages, subject mismatches, and the need for continuous specialized training. Students indirectly benefit through improved instructional delivery and enhanced learning experiences, and future researchers gain a valuable reference for further studies on teachers teaching non-specialized subjects, teacher development, and instructional effectiveness. Anchored on UN High-Level Panel (2024), and literature on teachers teaching non-specialized subjects, this study ultimately contributes to broader national and global goals of ensuring inclusive, equitable, and high-quality education under Sustainable Development Goal 4.

1.2 REVIEW OF RELATED LITERATURE

The information, study literature, and conceptual material that have already been published and are relevant to the subject at hand are reviewed in this chapter. It helps researchers better understand and provides the basic information they need to plan and carry out the study.

Teaching is quite laborious supports the multifaceted task of teaching as the noblest of all professions, as it lays the foundation for any discipline they desire (Leonin,2024). Teaching is widely recognized as one of the most vital and noble professions worldwide. Ideally, teachers are assigned based on their specialized subjects, qualifications, and professional training (Buenacosa & Petallo, 2022). There are instances when they are required to teach beyond the area of their expertise. Such teachers are commonly referred to as teachers teaching non-specialized subjects (Buenacosa & Petallo, 2022).

Teaching non-specialized subjects refers to the assignment of teachers to instruct in areas for which they lack the appropriate training, qualifications, or expertise. This may involve teaching subjects,

grade levels, or school types outside their certified specialization. According to, Hobbs and Whannell (2020) as cited by Perez, (2024) this practice involves deploying teachers to roles for which they do not possess the necessary qualifications or relevant knowledge in a particular subject or grade level. Similarly, Co et al. (2021), describe teachers of non-specialized subjects as those who are trained in one field but are required to teach in another.

Teaching non-specialized subject is a prevalent issue that affects teacher effectiveness, student learning, and overall school performance (Hobbs & Porsch, 2021). This phenomenon is particularly common in rural areas due to teacher shortages, recruitment challenges, and limited access to resources (Rodriguez, 2025).

Teachers who teach outside of their area face many challenges. Study of Rodriguez, (2025) emphasizes that teachers teaching non-specialized subjects encountered lack of subject knowledge, classroom management, and support and resources. The study of Ogundairo,(2024) highlights that these teachers also face psychological challenges. Moreover, Salvador et.al (2022), found that teachers teaching non-specialized subjects adapt to the challenges they encounter by relying on several key adaptations often focus on learning from seasoned teachers, learning from textbooks, learning from schemes of work, and training and seminars. Furthermore, Gomez & Petalla, (2025) highlighted that these teachers also using technology to navigate unfamiliar content and instructional demands, demonstrating that digital tools have become an essential component of their adaptation.

Challenges

Teachers assigned to teach subjects outside their specialization encounter multifaceted challenges that significantly impact their instructional effectiveness and professional well-being. The most prominent difficulties include insufficient content knowledge and mastery of unfamiliar subject matter (Espiritu and Espiritu, 2025) and Gaso (2025), which directly affects their ability to deliver quality instruction. These

teachers struggle with fundamental pedagogical tasks such as lesson planning, designing appropriate assessments, and staying current with curriculum changes (Gaso, (2025); (Roxas, 2022). The lack of adequate professional development opportunities and institutional support compounds these challenges, leaving teachers without the necessary resources and training to effectively navigate unfamiliar content areas (Magtulis & Brunio, 2025; Ciata et al., 2024). Additionally, teachers face difficulties in developing innovative instructional strategies and accessing appropriate teaching materials for subjects outside their expertise (Magtulis & Brunio, 2025; Tope, 2023). These challenges often result in increased stress, potential burnout, and reduced job satisfaction, ultimately affecting both teacher performance and student learning outcomes (Tope, 2023; Ciata et al., 2024). The problem is further exacerbated by administrative decisions and teacher shortages that necessitate such assignments, creating a systemic issue that requires targeted interventions including specialized training programs, mentorship, and strategic teacher placement based on subject specialization (Gaso, 2025; Candelario & Abo, 2025).

Lack of Subject Knowledge

Teachers teaching non-specialized subjects face a wide range of challenges that affects their teaching competence and overall effectiveness. Studies indicates that these teachers experience content knowledge challenges. This includes lack of subject or content knowledge mastery (Hobbs and Porsch, 2021; Rebucas, 2022; Rodriguez, 2025) and concept application (Arendain and Limpot, 2022;Hobbs and Porsch, 2021; Osman and Villocino, 2024; Pacaña, 2019; Rebucas, 2022; and Tope, 2023).

In addition, content knowledge is the knowledge about the learning material or subject to be taught (Maharani & Hongki, 2025). However, finding of Hobbs and Porsch (2021), Rebucas (2022), Rodriguez, 2025) emphasize that teaching beyond one's area of specialization often results in limited subject knowledge mastery and conceptual understanding. A lack of subject knowledge is at the core of

the teaching non-specialized subjects problem (Buenacosa & Petalla, 2022; Gomez & Petalla, 2025; Luft et al., 2020).

Teachers who lack sufficient subject knowledge may reduce students' confidence and restrict meaningful learning opportunities, leading learners to develop only surface-level understanding (Nakar & Du Plesis, 2023). Mizzi (2022) also explains that teachers often struggle to transfer knowledge to new subject areas if they lack a strong subject foundation. This situation can affect their confidence, instructional decision-making, and ability to keep students engaged.

Lack of subject knowledge often leads to difficulty in conceptual understanding and application on the part of the teacher (Arendain & Limpot, 2022; Hobbs & Porsch, 2021). They might understand basic concepts but struggle to explain and apply their practical applications in real-life situations or problem-solving tasks accurately.

Findings of Tope (2023) underscore that teachers teaching non-specialized subjects often struggle to provide real-world examples or activities that help students apply what they learn in an authentic context. The application of concepts plays a crucial role in the teaching–learning process, especially for teachers assigned to teach subjects outside their field of specialization. It has been observed that teaching non-specialized subjects significantly challenges teachers in delivering instruction that promotes deep conceptual understanding among learners.

Similar findings were reported in the studies of Osman and Villocino, (2024), Pacaña, (2019), and Rebucas, (2022) showing that teachers assigned outside their specialization struggle with concept depth and in creating meaningful lessons, which links to the concept-application challenge.

Classroom Management

Classroom management is an essential component of effective teaching. Nonetheless, numerous recent empirical studies have indicated that teachers teaching non-specialized subjects frequently encounter difficulties in effectively managing classrooms. Classroom management issues, such as student behavior and the need for diversified pedagogies and pedagogical strength (Klusmann et al., 2008), as cited by Du Plessis & McDonagh, 2021). These challenges were mainly due to limited subject matter knowledge and influenced the teacher's pedagogical content knowledge (Bugwak, 2021; Du Plessis, 2019; Caneda & Biol, 2025). Rodriguez (2025) revealed a notable struggle of teachers teaching non-specialized subjects to maintain student engagement, with most of the teachers (52.4%) saying that they agree that students are more likely to lose interest and not engage.

Similar findings appeared in a study by Bugwak (2021), Travails of Out-of-Field Teachers: A Qualitative Inquiry, which documented teachers' narratives describing their struggles in maintaining student discipline and attention when they lack confidence in their lessons. The study reported that establishing classroom authority and using teaching approaches becomes difficult when teachers are assigned to teach outside their field of expertise. Their limited content mastery often leads to less engaging lessons, which weakens students' interest and attention. As students perceive the teacher's lack of expertise, they are less likely to listen, as they tend to question the teacher's credibility and authority in the classroom. Supporting this, Castro et al., (2023) emphasized that low self-efficacy among teachers teaching non-specialized subjects weakens their classroom authority. When teachers lack confidence in their ability to handle both content and student discipline, their classroom authority is weakened. In contrast, findings of Caneda and Biol, (2025)contradicted the assumption that teachers teaching non-specialized subjects experienced difficulty in managing classrooms due to a lack of confidence in teaching the subject matter. The study stated that despite teaching a different area from their specialization, teachers teaching non-specialized subjects were capable of building a classroom environment that could

cater to the diversity of learners and promote active learning. While teachers teaching non-specialized subjects experienced several challenges, particularly in delivering the concept of the subject matter, the teachers teaching non-specialized subjects pedagogical experiences, training, and knowledge had helped them to create a learning environment that was conducive to diverse learners.

Support and Resources

Teachers teaching non-specialized subjects face significant challenges related to inadequate support and limited resources, which substantially impact their teaching effectiveness and professional confidence. Hobbs (2020) emphasizes the evolving learning needs of teachers teaching non-specialized subjects, identifying five categories of learning that shift over time, indicating a need for contextual support. Magdaraog and Benavides, (2020) report that teachers teaching non-specialized subjects in Sorsogon struggle with limited resources, insufficient training, and a lack of equipment, while relying on peer consultation as an adaptation. In the study of Rodriguez (2025) identify challenges faced by teachers in out-of-field education, including funding constraints and inadequate administrative support.

Study of Espiritu and Espiritu, (2025) and Dela Cruz et al. (2025) , teachers face challenges in non-specialized subjects such lack of content knowledge, inadequate resources, and insufficient professional development; support from professional development, mentorship, and resources can enhance effectiveness. While Magtulis & Brunio, (2025)found that lack of school-based assistance and the need for innovative instructional strategies were the most pressing institutional concerns among 32 science teachers. These findings are corroborated by Tope, (2023) who emphasized that schools must provide non-specialized teachers with necessary resources and support systems to manage workload effectively and reduce stress and burnout. Ciata et al., (2024) further documented how insufficient training and limited access to resources negatively impact both teaching effectiveness and student outcomes, while Gaso,

(2025) revealed that administrative decisions and teacher shortages often force educators into non-specialized roles without adequate institutional preparation. The institutional support gap extends to equipment and materials, as Dela Cruz et al. (2025) found that non-TLE teachers faced significant challenges due to insufficient resources and limited access to necessary equipment when teaching Technical and Livelihood Education subjects.

Psychological Challenges

Several empirical studies highlight that teaching non-specialized subjects not only affects instructional quality but also the teacher's mental and emotional state. Findings of Ogundairo, (2024) revealed that teachers teaching non-specialized subjects experience notable psychological and professional challenges, yet they also demonstrate strong coping abilities and resilience. Teachers teaching non-specialized subjects reported feeling stress, anxiety, and self-doubt due to teaching subjects they were not trained. They expressed constant fear of being judged by students or colleagues and frustration over the extra workload required to prepare lessons. Similarly, (Hobbs and Porsch, (2021) also reported that teachers teaching non-specialized subjects feel frustration because pressure to meet the institution's performance expectations for positive learning outcomes, forces them to learn unfamiliar content while still expected to teach effectively, which can weaken their motivation and self-efficacy.

On the other hand, findings of Nakar & Du Plesis (2023) revealed that teachers who teach subjects they do not know well tend to feel more stressed and less confident in their jobs because their qualifications do not align with the criteria used to judge their performance.

Study of Anselmo et al., 2024) teaching non-specialized subjects is closely tied to psychological challenges. Feelings of insecurity, uncertainty about the subject matter, and difficulty grasping unfamiliar material contribute to emotional distress, including stress and anxiety. At the same time, Anselmo's findings highlight that teachers attempt to counter this strain through adaptive efforts such as increased

preparation, reliance on peer support, strategic workload management, and continuous professional development.

Study of Caldis (2022), in *Out-of-Field Teaching: New Teachers Survive Under Pressure*, found that most new teachers felt "overwhelmed" by their out-of-field assignments, with one reporting serious anxiety. They attributed this pressure to the dual demand of mastering content knowledge while delivering lessons effectively, further compounded by classroom management challenges. This finding is similar to the statement of Ogundairo, (2024) that out-of-field teachers frequently report feeling underprepared, overwhelmed by lesson planning, and insecure about their content knowledge. Maslach and Leiter (2016) as cited by Ogundairo (2024), stated that over time, such stress can lead to burnout, a condition characterized by fatigue, cynicism, and reduced professional accomplishment.

Adaptation

Teachers demonstrate remarkable adaptability when teaching non-specialized subjects through a combination of self-directed learning strategies, technological integration, and collaborative support systems. Research reveals that educators employ adaptive teaching methods and resourcefulness in instructional material development as their most common adaption (Magtulis and Brunio, 2025) utilizing extensive reading, internet research, and seeking help from colleagues (Pilar & Militante, 2020). Teachers successfully integrate technology such as YouTube videos, role-playing activities, and interactive board work to overcome content knowledge gaps Roxas, (2022) while also engaging in time and workload management, adapting teaching methods, and pursuing professional development opportunities (Tope, 2023). This adaptation process proves effective, with studies showing very high levels of adaptive strategies and performance among non-specialized teachers and notably, four out of ten teachers eventually learning to appreciate handling non-specialized subjects (Candelario & Abo, 2025). The

success of teacher adaptation is further enhanced when supported by professional development programs, mentorship, and access to teaching resources, which significantly mitigate challenges and improve teaching effectiveness (Espiritu & Espiritu, 2025).

Learning from seasoned teachers

Learning from seasoned teachers through mentoring, collaboration, and peer support also emerges as a key adaption and professional growth mechanism among teachers teaching non-specialized subjects and novice teachers. This strategy anchored to the Social Constructivism Theory, stresses the concept of the More Knowledgeable Others (MKO), like mentors or peers who possesses a higher level of understanding and can provide the necessary guidance (Mcleod, 2025; Vygotsky, 1978).

Study of Salvador et al. (2022) in *Exploring Technical-Vocational Education Teachers' Challenges and Adaptation Strategies in Teaching Courses Outside their Specialization,* found that learning from seasoned teachers in the fields are big help for teachers teaching non-specialized subjects to adapt with the challenges they experience. The study highlighted that seasoned teachers are with expertise, mastery, and experience, they can share their knowledge and teaching skills in a certain subject. As a result, they can boost teachers teaching non-specialized subject confidence to look at its brighter side as learning is a continuous process.

Similarly, study Caldis (2022), novice teachers teaching non-specialized subjects engage with experts and mentoring programs to cope with the challenges. Quality mentoring and induction programs, often led by experienced teachers, significantly shape novice teachers' professional trajectories and influence their decision to remain in the profession, as they help new teachers "gain their footing" and develop confidence in instructional decision-making (Sydnor et al., 2024) .

Teachers who were not specialized in Physical Science significantly benefited from the mentorship, guidance, and informal coaching of more experienced colleagues within their schools (Abrantes &

Bargamento, 2024). The study's participants described "peer mentoring" and "collaborative learning" as essential supports that helped them manage instructional challenges and improve content delivery.

Through this dependence, mentorship becomes the initial bridge that supports them in understanding the subject matter and reducing feelings of inadequacy that typically accompany teaching outside one's specialization (Abenes & Caballes, 2020). Similar findings echoed in the study of De La Cruz and Alda (2024), reported that English teachers teaching non-specialized subjects actively seek seasoned teachers not only for content explanations but also for practical teaching materials and strategy sharing. This indicates that mentorship is not a one-time interaction but a continuous, experience-driven learning path that helps teachers adjust to the demands of their unintended teaching assignments.

Learning from textbooks

Several studies have emphasized the crucial role of teaching resources and materials in supporting teachers who are assigned to teach subjects outside their specialization. Perez, (2024) highlighted that teachers who taught subjects beyond their area of expertise were able to increase their content knowledge and develop flexibility by utilizing books and other instructional materials to bridge their knowledge gaps. These teachers also demonstrated resourcefulness by consulting subject experts and seeking out relevant resources to enhance their teaching effectiveness.

Similarly, Espiritu and Espiritu, (2025) found that increasing access to teaching resources and materials ranked as the fourth most significant strategy (38% of responses) for improving the teaching experience of non-specialized teachers. Access to textbooks, online resources, educational tools, and other instructional materials enabled these teachers to prepare and deliver lessons more effectively.

In the same vein, Edulan and Fajardo, (2024) reported that out-of-field teachers made frequent use of textbooks and supplementary materials, in addition to digital platforms, to facilitate effective

teaching and learning. This practice not only enhanced their instructional delivery but also deepened learners' understanding and engagement.

Hobbs and Porsch, (2021) observed that teachers initially face a steep learning curve when teaching outside their field; however, they gradually gain confidence and competence through trial, reflection, and continuous preparation. These teachers actively developed lesson plans and gathered instructional materials—especially books—to build their subject knowledge over time, which positively contributed to their pedagogical skills and self-efficacy.

Similarly, Co et al., (2021) found that Senior High School Science teachers teaching outside their specialization invested significant time in studying content and compensating for knowledge gaps by using supplementary resources such as videos, online materials, and books. This sustained learning effort served as a key coping mechanism and contributed to their overall pedagogical development.

Learning from schemes of work

Schemes of work help teachers adapt by providing a structured framework for professional learning and instructional flexibility. Moore et al., (2021) found that curriculum materials like schemes of work catalyze change in teachers' practices by creating interconnected networks of professional development. The research suggests that these materials are not just static documents, but dynamic tools that mediate between school practices and research insights.

Kimwarey, (2022) further revealed that scheme of work preparation is crucial for teacher training, though implementation can be uneven. Hobbs and Porsch, (2021) discusses research showing that newly hired teachers teaching non-specialized subjects benefit from access to high-quality instructional materials, including schemes of work, and in-school mentoring structures. Hobbs and colleagues argue these schemes provide essential scaffolding for lesson preparation and classroom delivery, supporting teachers in curriculum planning and fostering adaptive expertise.

However, related learning processes are evident in the literature of Pilar and Militante, (2020) identified themes of “extensive reading and searching” and “internet resourcing” as ways teachers acquire content knowledge for unfamiliar subjects. Magtulis and Brunio, (2025) found that teachers employed “resourcefulness in instructional material development” and “adaptive teaching methods” when handling non-specialized subjects. Espiritu and Espiritu, (2025) emphasized that access to teaching resources and structured professional development programs significantly enhance teacher effectiveness in non-specialized roles.

The findings on the effect of teachers' professional knowledge and application on students’ examination scores; included the influence of the following on students' achievement; preparation and adherence to schemes of work, preparation of lesson notes, mastery of content by the teacher, lesson plan development and usage, marking or checking students work and adequate syllabus coverage. The findings showed that the bulk of teachers' respondents agreed teacher's professional knowledge and application had an influence on the academic performance of the students.

Training and Seminars

Training and seminar adaptation for teachers of non-specialized subjects requires targeted professional development, mentorship, and resource support to enhance teaching effectiveness. Espiritu and Espiritu, (2025) found that professional development programs, mentorship, and increased access to teaching resources significantly mitigate challenges faced by non-specialized teachers. Magtulis and Brunio, (2025) specifically recommended interventions like teacher exchange programs, interdisciplinary training, and peer mentoring to strengthen instructional adaptability. Julia et al., (2020) demonstrated through action research that targeted training helps non-specialist teachers develop basic subject knowledge and improve teaching skills using media and applications. Castro et al., (2024)emphasized that

current teaching assignments often require educators to teach beyond their expertise, highlighting the urgent need for systematic training adaptation to ensure effective instruction across subject areas.

Using technology to navigate

Teachers are increasingly using technology as a critical navigational tool when teaching subjects outside their specialized expertise. Gomez and Petalla, (2025) highlights how teachers teaching non-specialized subjects adapt their teaching challenges by engaging in online research. This is especially true for teachers teaching non-specialized subjects, who must conduct thorough research to find valid information on the subjects they will be teaching (Arendain & Limpot,2022).

Study of Roxas, (2022) provides foundational evidence that teachers utilize ICT tools including YouTube videos, role playing, board works, and class reporting as adaptation when navigating subjects outside their expertise. This study specifically identifies technology as essential for lesson planning, activity preparation, and content mastery in unfamiliar subject areas.

In addition, Magtulis & Brunio, (2025) demonstrate that adaption supported by technology represent the most commonly employed strategy for science teachers handling non-specialized subjects. Their research emphasizes resourcefulness in instructional material development through digital platforms as crucial for navigating interdisciplinary teaching challenges.

In line with this, study of Tingzon and Buyok, (2022) provide comprehensive evidence that non-TLE teachers extensively use technology as a navigation tool for class discussions, skill demonstrations, and accessing required equipment information. Their phenomenological study reveals that technology serves as a primary coping strategy for teachers lacking specialized knowledge and resources.

Moreover, Dela Cruz et al., (2025) emphasize technology integration as a crucial recommendation for empowering non-TLE teachers. Their research identifies technology as essential for collaborative growth and addressing resource challenges when teaching outside areas of expertise.

Furthermore, Espiritu and Espiritu, (2025) provide systematic evidence that access to technological teaching resources significantly mitigates challenges faced by teachers in non-specialized roles. Their mixed-methods research demonstrates that technology support directly enhances teacher effectiveness across unfamiliar subject areas.

Teachers Profile

The teachers' profiles are important parts of this study, as they provide valuable insights into the challenges teachers encounter and the ways they adapt to address them. Several studies support the idea that teachers' experiences with challenges and their ability to adapt to classroom and workplace changes are influenced by factors such as sex, level of education, years of teaching, area of specialization, the subject outside their specialization, and school location.

Sex

The review shows that gender plays a minimal role in determining the level of challenges or the adaptation of teachers teaching non-specialized subjects. Studies such as Beley (2025) and Candelario & Abo (2025) include gender in their teacher profiles but report no statistically significant differences between male and female teachers in challenge intensity or adaptation. According to Badaru & Ndlovu (2025), across the studies reviewed, gender has been consistently treated as a demographic descriptor rather than a determinant variable. Consequently, there is negligible empirical evidence to support the notion that male and female teachers differ in the degree of difficulty they face when teaching outside their specialization, or in how they adapt to such conditions.

Qualification

Teacher qualifications play a significant role in affecting both the problems that teachers face and the changes they make. According to research such Rutgers et al. (2025), teachers with advanced degrees or professional training are better at mastering the subject matter and adapting their teaching methods, making the challenges of teaching subjects outside their primary area of expertise less severe. Study of Villano-ac (2024) found that teachers with advanced degrees or additional certifications were more flexible, confident, and able to handle subjects outside their primary areas of expertise. Having more education gives teachers more teaching tools, a better understanding of their subjects, and more confidence in their own abilities, which helps them do their non-specialized teaching jobs better.

Years of Teaching

Research has repeatedly shown that teachers' experience is a key factor in how well they adapt when put in charge of classes outside their primary area of expertise. In Ghana Agormedah et al., (2022) discovered that teachers with more years of experience were much more confident in their ability to use effective teaching methods, keep students interested, and run a well-organized classroom. Suggesting that teachers' confidence and ability to adapt are raised by the knowledge they have gained over time. Similarly, Orakci et al. (2023) reported that experienced teachers tend to build stronger self-efficacy through reflective practices and problem-solving approaches. Study of Pressley et al., (2023) also found that teachers with more experience felt greater control of their lessons and more confident, even during the pandemic demonstrating how established routines can help maintain stability in uncertain situations.

Additionally, Wheeley et al. (2023) on the other hand, reported that new and aspiring teachers often struggled in out-of-field situations because they lacked sufficient subject knowledge or classroom

experience. All of these studies strongly suggest that the number of years a teacher has been working directly affects how they handle challenges and tasks outside their primary area of expertise.

Area of Specialization

One of the most important factors determining both the level of difficulty and the student's ability to adapt is the teacher's original area of expertise. Study of Candelario & Abo (2025), shows that when teachers are assigned subjects outside their primary area of expertise, they have more work to do, feel more stressed, and have less confidence in their ability to teach the material. These problems happen because teachers are not adequately trained about the subject. However, this mismatch between specialization and assignment also encourages proactive adaptation behaviors, such as working with peers, planning lessons for more extended periods, and learning professionally on your own . Villano-ac (2024), found that teachers' hard work and years of experience in their fields greatly help students learn new information, skills, and attitudes. Helping the country grow by making students globally competitive with 21st-century skills. Every student should get a free, high-quality education at every level.

Subjects Handled out of Specialization

Along with specialization, the number and types of subjects that teachers have to teach make the problems they face even worse. According to Dela Cruz et al. (2025) and Fullido (2025), teachers who teach more than one non-specialized subject experience greater content-related stress and greater difficulty managing their workload than teachers who teach only their specialization.

Studies in Southeast Asia underscore similar issues. Sari and Wulandari, (2025) states that in due to a persistent shortage of subject-specialist teachers in Indonesia, particularly in rural areas, many teachers have been required to teach subjects outside their areas of specialization, resulting to lower-quality instruction and uneven student outcomes. This finding is similar to the study of Ng, (2019) and Lim

and Wang, (2025) in Malaysia, which revealed that assigning teachers to handle subjects out of specialization continues due to insufficient staffing. In Thailand, (Hallinger and Bryant (2020) and Klanrit and Sroinam,2022) emphasized ongoing reforms and the decentralization of education have made teachers responsible for many subjects—often those beyond their primary areas of expertise—making it more challenging to maintain high teaching standards, particularly in subjects such as Physical Education and Social Studies. In the Philippines, study of Abanilla et al. (2023 and Parreño et al. (2025) in Iloilo City, many teachers assigned to handle new curricular demands even though they have not received any specialized training. A similar pattern can be seen in the study of Dela Cruz et al. (2025) in Batangas, where a shortage of qualified teachers and a broad K–12 curriculum have forced many teachers to teach subjects they are unfamiliar with. Studies show that assigning teachers to subjects they do not know much about makes lessons less effective, reduces students' interest, and may worsen educational inequality, especially in communities that are already struggling and have few resources (Darling-Hammond (2020); Martinez & Sanchez, (2025). When teachers' qualifications do not match their assignments, lessons are less consistent, teachers are less confident, and it is harder for students to learn and acquire the skills they need.

School Location

School location is identified as one of the intervening factors that influence how teachers teaching non-specialized subjects experience and adapt. Badaru and Ndlovu (2025) review revealed that teaching non-specialized subjects is most common in rural schools with limited resources. Similar findings were reported in the study published in the International Journal of Research and Innovation in Social Science, which highlighted that teachers in remote areas face logistical challenges, resource shortages, and isolation (Fabrigas & Paglinawan, 2025) .The lack of instructional resources, professional support, and access to continuous training makes it more difficult for teachers to handle subjects beyond their primary areas of expertise. According to Van Nuland et al. (2020) remote teaching often suffers from inadequate

infrastructure. Teachers face challenges like unreliable internet access and limited teaching materials. And teachers in remote areas report feelings of isolation due to distance from family and colleagues.

1.3 Theoretical Framework

Teaching non-specialized subjects presents a multidimensional experience that demands pedagogical flexibility, professional resilience, and adaptive capacity. This study, “Challenges and Adaptations of Teachers Teaching Non-Specialized Subjects,” is grounded on several educational, psychological, and sociological theories that explain how teachers experience and manage instructional assignments beyond their field of expertise.

At the core of this study is anchored to the Person–Environment Fit Theory (Caplan, 1987), which asserts that an individual’s job satisfaction and performance are highly influenced by the congruence between their personal characteristics (skills, values, and abilities) and their work environment. PE fit occurs when individuals' characteristics align with those of their work environment. However, when personal needs, values, goals, abilities, and personalities differ from those of the organizational environment—which has distinct demands, resources, values, and culture—"fitting in" becomes an evolving process that triggers behavioral, cognitive, and affective responses (De Cooman et al. 2022). In educational contexts, when teachers are assigned to handle subjects outside their specialization, a misfit occurs, leading to stress, lowered self-efficacy, and professional discomfort. This misalignment explains the challenges teachers face in non-specialized teaching situations. Additionally, Person–Environment Fit Theory recognizes the tendency of individuals to use adaptive strategies to close the gap and restore equilibrium between themselves and their work Environment context. Consequently, the theory provides a strong foundation for understanding both the challenges and coping mechanisms of teachers in mismatched teaching assignments.

On the other hand, Role Theory, as discussed by Biddle (1986), states that human behavior is based on social roles, which are the expected behaviors tied to a specific social position. This theory highlighted that stress and conflict experienced when an individual faces incompatible expectations from a single role or multiple roles or when the expectations of their role do not align with their preparation or capacity to perform. In the teaching profession, being asked to handle subjects outside one's expertise can create role conflict, since teachers must perform duties for which they were not specifically prepared.

Supporting this perspective, Deng et al. (2022) found that teachers experiencing role ambiguity—unclear expectations and misaligned responsibilities—reported lower role practice and increased role stress. This mirrors the condition of teachers assigned to subjects outside their specialization, where the mismatch between expertise and task produces role conflict.

In conclusion, these theoretical backgrounds can be used to understand how teachers experience and manage instructional assignments beyond their field of expertise. They provide a comprehensive framework for understanding how out of field teachers grow, learn, and effectively respond to the challenges of their personal and professional environments.

1.3 Schematic Diagram

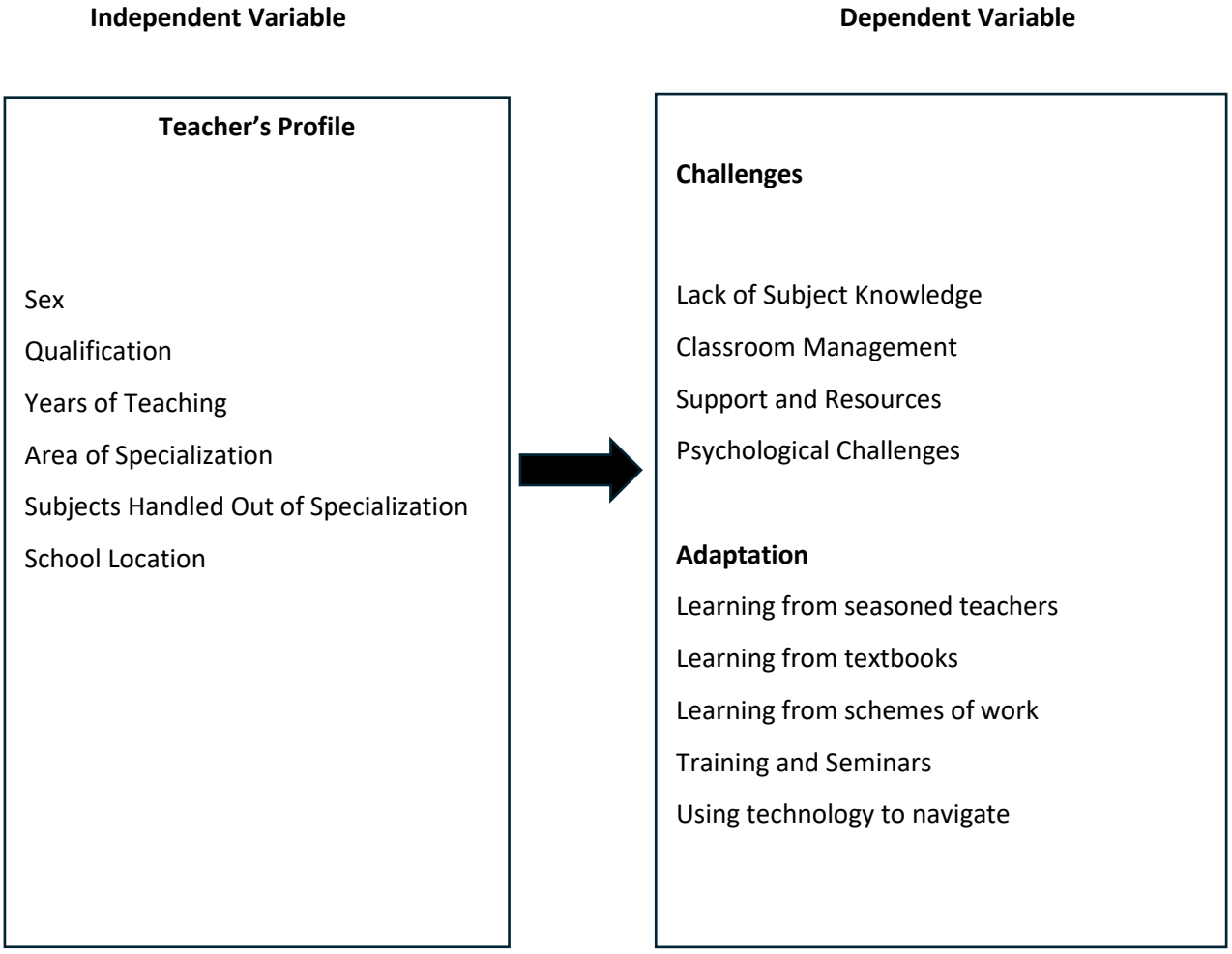


Figure 1: The figure shows the interplay of the variables of the study.

1.5 Statement of the Problem

The researchers aimed to determine the challenges and adaptations of teachers teaching non-specialized subjects. Specifically, this study aims to answer the following research questions;

1. What is the demographic profile of teachers teaching non-specialized subjects in terms of:

    1.1 Sex;

    1.2 Qualification;

    1.3 Years of Teaching;

    1.4 Area of Specialization;

    1.5 Subjects Handled Out of Specialization; and

    1.6 School Location?

2. What is the level of challenges experienced by teachers teaching non-specialized subjects in terms of:

    2.1 Lack of Subject Knowledge;

    2.2 Classroom Management;

    2.4 Support and Resources; and

    2.4 Psychological Challenges?

3. What is the level of adaptation employed by teachers teaching non-specialized subjects in terms of:

    3.1 Learning from seasoned teachers;

    3.2 Learning from textbooks;

    3.3 Learning from schemes of work;

    3.4 Training and Seminars; and

    3.5 Using technology to navigate?

4. Is there significant difference in the challenges faced by teachers teaching non- specialized subjects across their profiles?
5. Is there significant difference in the adaptation of teachers teaching non-specialized subjects across profiles?
6. Is there a significant relationship between the challenges faced by teachers teaching non-specialized subjects and their adaptation?

1.6 Hypothesis of the Study

The following hypothesis guided by the study and tested at a 0.05 level of significance.

HO1: There is no significant difference in the challenges faced by teachers teaching non-specialized subjects across profiles.

HO2: There is no significant difference in the adaptation teachers teaching non-specialized subjects across profiles.

HO3: There is no significant relationship between the challenges faced by teachers teaching non-specialized subjects and their adaptation.

Scope and Limitations

This study examines the challenges and adaptation of teachers assigned to teach subjects outside their field of specialization in BUENASCAR Agusan del Norte. Specifically, this study will focus on selected public and private secondary school teachers of: School A (15 teachers teaching non-specialized subjects), School B (10 teachers teaching non-specialized subjects), School C (20 teachers teaching non-specialized subjects), School D (9 teachers teaching non-specialized subjects), School E (30 teachers teaching non-specialized subjects), and School F (5 teachers teaching non-specialized subjects). Generally, these schools have a total of 89 teachers, which all identified teachers selected as respondents in the study.

This study also examines the primary challenges experienced by the teachers in BUENASCAR, Agusan del Norte, including a lack of subject knowledge, classroom management, support and resources, and psychological challenges. It also examines the adaptation employ, including learning from seasoned teachers, learning from textbooks, learning from schemes of work, training and seminars, and using technology.

This study will exclusively utilize a pre-determined survey questionnaire as its data-gathering tool. As a result, specific challenges experienced by out-of-field teachers and the full extent of their adaptation strategies may not be fully captured or explored. In addition, the sample size will be relatively small, which may influence the generalizability of the findings to a broader population of teachers. Furthermore, since the study will be conducted within selected schools in the BUENASCAR municipalities, the results may have limited applicability to other educational contexts that differ in demographic composition, institutional culture, or available resources.

1.7 Definition of Terms

The following terms were operationally defined for a more precise and better understanding of the study.

Adaptation. This refers to the strategies and adjustments teachers employ to effectively teach non-specialized subjects despite challenges in content mastery, resources, and confidence.

Area of Specialization. This refers to the specific academic discipline or field in which a teacher has received formal education, training, or certification, and is considered most competent to teach.

Challenges. This term refers to the difficulties teachers face when handling classes outside their field of expertise, particularly in mastering content, applying appropriate pedagogy, and maintaining confidence and instructional quality.

Classroom Management. This describes teachers' ability to maintain discipline, organize learning activities, and create a productive environment while teaching subjects outside their expertise.

Lack of Subject Knowledge. This refers to teachers' insufficient mastery of the content in the non-specialized subjects they are required to teach.

Learning from Schemes of Work. This refers to teachers' use of structured lesson guides or schemes of work to plan, organize, and deliver lessons in non-specialized subjects.

Learning from Seasoned Teachers. This refers to teachers' adaptation strategy of seeking guidance, mentorship, and instructional support from more experienced colleagues.

Learning from Textbooks. This describes teachers' strategy of relying on textbooks as primary sources to understand unfamiliar content in non-specialized subjects.

Psychological Challenges. This refers to emotional and mental difficulties such as stress, anxiety, or self-doubt experienced by teachers due to teaching subjects they did not specialize in.

Qualification. Denoting the teacher's highest educational attainment, professional credentials, and eligibility relevant to their teaching position or assigned subjects.

Sex. This refers to the biological classification of teachers as male or female as indicated in the study's demographic profile.

School Location. About the school's geographical setting—urban or rural —which may influence available resources, class size, and teaching conditions.

Subjects Handled Out of Specialization. Referring to the subjects assigned to a teacher that are outside his or her academic or professional field of expertise, requiring additional preparation or adaptation to deliver effective instruction.

Support and Resources. This pertains to the availability of institutional assistance, materials, equipment, and administrative backing provided to teachers handling non-specialized subjects.

Teachers Teaching Non-Specialized Subjects. This refers to a teacher assigned to teach subjects outside their area of specialization or formal academic training.

Training and Seminars. This pertains to teachers' participation in professional development activities to improve competence in teaching subjects outside their specialization.

Using Technology. This refers to teachers' use of digital tools, online resources, and educational platforms to enhance their understanding and delivery of non-specialized subjects.

Years of Teaching. This indicates the total number of years teachers have been engaged in professional teaching, reflecting their level of experience.

CHAPTER 2

METHODOLOGY

This chapter presents the research design, research materials and methods, research environment, population and sample, data analysis plan, and ethical standards.

2.1 Research Design

This study will employ a quantitative approach, utilizing descriptive-comparative research design and correlational approaches to systematically investigate the challenges and adaptations of teachers teaching outside their area of specialization. The descriptive-comparative approach will be used to determine and compare the levels of challenges and adaptation among teachers teaching non-specialized subjects across different profiles, including sex, qualification, years of teaching, area of specialization, subjects handled out of specialization, and school location. The correlational component will examine the relationship between the challenges encountered and the adaptation these teachers employ.

2.2 Research Locale

This study will be conducted in selected public and private high schools located in the municipalities of Buenavista, Nasipit, and Carmen (collectively referred to as BUENASCAR) in the province of Agusan del Norte, Caraga Region. Specifically, the study sites will include the following schools: School A, Purok 4, Brgy. Matabao, Agusan del Norte with the (8.97° North latitude and 125.42° East longitude), School B, in Brgy. 3 Buenavista, Agusan del Norte with the (8.975° North latitude and 125.410° East longitude), School C, in Bayview Hill, Barangay 7, Nasipit, Agusan del Norte with the (8°59'N, 125°20'E), School D, D-3 Culit, Nasipit Agusan del Norte with the (8.94° North latitude and 125.36° East longitude), School E, Cabatuan Carmen, Agusan del Norte with the (8.4698° N, 124.6319° E), and School F, which is

located at General Luna St. Poblacion, Carmen, Agusan del Norte with the (8.99° North latitude and 125.29° East longitude). These schools were purposively selected because they represent a mix of public and private secondary institutions within the BUENASCAR area. These schools have been identified as having teachers assigned to teach subjects outside their fields of specialization, making them appropriate sites for investigating the challenges and adaptation of teachers teaching non-specialized subjects. Additionally, these schools were chosen because a previous study, "The Challenges of Physical Education Teachers Teaching Non-P.E." (Descriptive-comparative approach) was also conducted in the same institutions.

2.3 Research Environment, Population and Sample

The study's respondents will be selected using a purposive sampling technique, specifically the total population sampling method, since all teachers teaching non-specialized subjects identified in the selected schools will be included as respondents. Teachers from selected private and public schools in BUENASCAR Agusan del Norte will be chosen by the researchers. As Aguinaldo (2021) explained, purposive sampling helps researchers access a specific group of individuals who fit a given profile. Therefore, in this study, the researchers selected participants based on their suitability to provide the required responses.

This study has a total of eighty-nine (89) respondents, where fifteen (15) teachers from School A, ten (10) teachers from School B, twenty (20) teachers are from School C, nine (9) teachers from School D, thirty (30) teachers from School E, and five (5) teachers from School F. These numbers will represent the teachers who will participate in the study, ensuring that the results will reflect their experiences.

Table 1

Number of Teachers teaching non-specialized per School

School	Number of Teachers Teaching Non-Specialized Subjects
School A	15
School B	10
School C	20
School D	9
School E	30
School F	5
Total	89

Note. This table shows the total number of teachers assigned to teach subjects outside their area of specialization in each participating school.

Research Instrument

The research instrument that will be used in this will be adopted from the validated indicators and survey questionnaire developed by Rizzie D. Rodriguez (2025) in the article *"Out-Of-Field Teaching in Rural Senior High Schools: Prevalence, Challenges, Support, and Impact on Job Satisfaction"* published in *Psychology and Education:* variables such as; lack of subject knowledge, classroom management, and support and resources. While, psychological challenges will utilized researcher-made survey questionnaire since there was no indicator or survey questionnaire in the study.

The questionnaire consists of four (4) major parts, with each part representing a specific category of teachers' challenges identified in the review of literature: (1) Lack of Subject Knowledge, (2) Classroom Management, (3) Support and Resources, (4) Psychological challenges. Each part contains six (6) items, for a total of twenty- four (24). The respondents will answer each item using a 4-point Likert scale: 1- Strongly Disagree, 2- Disagree, 3-Agree, 4-Strongly Agree.

Section 1:

Teachers profile – The purpose of this study is to determine the profile of teachers in terms of sex, educational qualification, years of teaching experience, area of specialization, subjects handled outside their specialization, and school location. It further aims to examine the relationship between these profile variables and teachers' effectiveness in teaching non-specialized subjects.

Section 2: Challenges

Part I: Lack of Subject Knowledge (6 items) This part focuses on the teachers' difficulty in mastering the content of subjects they were assigned to teach outside their specialization. Rodriguez (2025) described this as a core impediment in teaching non-specialized subjects, where teachers experience limited subject matter knowledge (SMK), which affects lesson planning, classroom delivery, and confidence. The items under this part capture teachers' struggles with lesson preparation, conceptual understanding, and ability to answer student questions, as well as the need for continuous professional development and mentoring to improve pedagogical content knowledge.

Part II: Classroom Management (6 items) This section measures how teachers teaching non-specialized subjects assignments influence teachers' ability to manage student behavior, maintain engagement, and establish authority in the classroom. According to Rodriguez (2025), OOF teachers often face difficulties in maintaining discipline and student participation because of uncertainty in the subject matter. These classroom management challenges may lead to low student motivation, reduced learning outcomes, and increased teacher frustration. This part reflects teachers' perceptions of their classroom control, ability to engage students, and confidence in handling subject-related behavior issues.

Part III: Support and Resources (6 items) This part explores teachers' access to institutional support, instructional materials, mentorship, and professional development opportunities. Rodriguez (2025)

reported that teachers teaching non-specialized subjects often face inadequate resources and limited training, leading to feelings of isolation and lack of administrative support. Items in this section evaluate the availability and adequacy of teaching materials, collaboration opportunities, training relevance, and administrative responsiveness. The data in the original study indicated that most teachers rated existing support as only *partially effective*, highlighting a need for better-targeted assistance and continuous mentoring programs.

Part IV: Psychological Challenges (6 items) This section, developed by the researcher, measures emotional and psychological difficulties associated with out-of-field teaching — including stress, anxiety, self-doubt, and burnout. As Ogundario (2024) emphasized, teachers teaching non-specialized subjects experience emotional distress and decreased self-efficacy due to insecurity about their subject competence. Psychological strain manifests as fatigue, loss of motivation, and lowered job satisfaction. This part captures the teachers' mental and emotional well-being in relation to their teaching non-specialized subjects responsibilities, complementing the other three variables that focus on external and instructional challenges.

Section3: Adaptation

In adaptation variable, the researchers will be utilized a researcher-made survey questionnaire. This questionnaire will be designed to gather quantitative data relevant to the objectives of the study. It will consist of structured items formulated based on a review of related literature and studies to ensure content validity and relevance. The instrument will be subjected to expert validation and pilot testing prior to its administration to ensure its reliability and clarity.

The questionnaire consists of four (5) major parts, with each part representing a specific category of teachers' adaptation identified in the review of literature: (1) Learning from seasoned teachers, (2)

Learning from textbooks, (3) Learning from schemes of work, (4) Training and Seminars, Salvador et al. (2022), and (5) Using Technology, Gomez & Petalla (2022). Each part contains six (6) items, for a total of thirty (3). The respondents will answer each item using a 4-point Likert scale: 1- Strongly Disagree, 2-Disagree, 3-Agree, 4-Strongly Agree.

Part I: Learning from Seasoned Teachers (6 items) This section describes how teachers seek guidance and mentorship from experienced or veteran colleagues to cope with teaching subjects outside their specialization. According to Salvador et al. (2022), seasoned teachers play a crucial role in supporting less experienced teachers by sharing their expertise, teaching techniques, and classroom strategies. This adaptation fosters professional growth, confidence, and pedagogical improvement, helping teachers to adjust positively to new teaching environments. Through observation, mentoring, and constructive feedback, novice or teachers teaching non-specialized subjects acquire methodological and professional knowledge, and learn to accept challenges as opportunities for continuous learning.

Part II: Learning from Textbooks (6 items) This part focuses on how teachers utilize textbooks and instructional materials as primary learning resources when teaching unfamiliar subjects. Textbooks serve as structured guides that provide comprehensive lesson content, activities, and references. Salvador et al. (2022) highlighted that textbooks enable teachers to understand lesson flow, key concepts, and pedagogical approaches systematically. They also promote active learning and concept mastery, ensuring that teachers can deliver topics with greater confidence and accuracy. By relying on well-designed textbooks, teachers enhance both their subject matter knowledge and instructional efficiency, making them better prepared to meet students' learning needs.

Part III: Learning from Schemes of Work (6 items) This section measures how teachers adapt through collaboration and shared planning with colleagues, often guided by the school's *schemes of work*—standardized lesson frameworks outlining objectives, pacing, and content. The study emphasized that

consulting peers and reviewing existing schemes of work helps teachers understand curriculum expectations and best practices. This process not only clarifies subject sequences and assessment methods but also encourages team learning and reflective practice, enhancing instructional confidence. By integrating insights from experienced colleagues and structured schemes, teachers can align their teaching with institutional standards and improve lesson coherence.

Part IV: Training and Seminars (6 items) This part assesses teachers' participation in formal professional development programs such as workshops, training sessions, and seminars. Salvador et al. (2022) found that these programs significantly improve teachers' competence, confidence, and innovation in teaching outside their specialization. Training provides opportunities for teachers to gain updated knowledge, explore teaching strategies, and exchange ideas with peers. It also enhances their ability to experiment with new methodologies, leading to improved classroom practices and motivation. Furthermore, professional training fosters career growth and morale, equipping teachers with essential skills for both content mastery and pedagogical adaptation.

Part V: Using Technology (6 items) This section evaluates how teachers utilize technological tools and digital platforms as adaption in teaching subjects beyond their expertise. With the increasing integration of ICT in education, teachers turn to technology for lesson preparation, instructional delivery, and student engagement. Technology provides access to online resources, video tutorials, simulations, and interactive materials that enhance comprehension and lesson quality.

2.4 Data Gathering Procedure

The data will be ordered and analyzed through the following procedure:

Letter of Approval—The researchers will initiate the data-gathering process by formally addressing a letter of approval to the principals of the selected schools. The letter will serve as a formal request for permission to conduct the study within their respective schools. It will also seek authorization to obtain the list of teachers teaching non-specialized subjects who will serve as respondents.

Informed Consent—Before the distribution of the questionnaires, the researchers will provide the participants with a clear explanation of the purpose of the study. Respondents will be required to sign an informed consent form before participating in the study.

Distribution of Survey Questionnaires—After securing approval and consent, the researchers will distribute the survey questionnaires to the identified out-of-field teachers in the selected schools. The questionnaire will be personally administered or distributed, depending on the accessibility and preference of the respondents.

Retrieval of Questionnaires—After the allotted response period, the researchers will personally retrieve the accomplished questionnaires from the respondents.

Gathering Data—The data collected from the retrieved questionnaires will be checked for completeness, tallied, and encoded for analysis. Results will be presented, analyzed, and interpreted using appropriate statistical tool

Data Analysis—The data will be statistically analyzed using descriptive statistics to summarize the respondents' profiles and responses. Inferential statistics, to determine significant differences across groups and the relationship between the challenges faced and the adaptation strategies employed by teachers teaching non-specialized subjects.

Data Analysis Plan and Procedure

The data will be statistically analyzed using descriptive statistics (mean, standard deviation, frequency, and percentage) to summarize the respondents' profiles and responses. Inferential statistics, such as the t-test and Analysis of Variance (ANOVA), will be used to determine significant differences across groups. The Pearson r correlation will be employed to determine the relationship between the challenges faced and the adaptation employed by teachers teaching non-specialized subjects.

2.5 Research Ethical Standards

The researchers will uphold the highest ethical standards in the conduct of this study. They will have the responsibility to respect and protect the rights and welfare of the respondents who will participate. The study will strictly follow established ethical guidelines to ensure honesty, integrity, and objectivity throughout the research process. It will also safeguard the respondents' privacy, confidentiality, and autonomy. The following ethical standards will guide this research:

A. Intellectual Property Rights (IPR) - This research will not involve any new technology, process, or product that requires patent protection. It respects and upholds intellectual property rights. Thus, to uphold intellectual property rights, the researcher will ensure that all materials used are appropriately credited and protected under copyright laws. All third-party sources and secondary data will be appropriately acknowledged. Since the study will not create any brand, logo, or symbol, trademark registration will not be necessary.

B. Informed Consent - Before the study commenced, the researcher sought and obtained formal approval from relevant authorities. This included permission from school heads to the different schools in BUENASCAR, to ensure the study aligned with the educational policies and regulations. This process ensures that participants fully understand the study's purpose, procedures, possible risks, and benefits, allowing them to make an informed decision about their involvement.

C. Data Privacy and Confidentiality - Participant's private information will be handled with utmost confidentiality. Data will be collected through questionnaires and codes will be used to maintain participants' confidentiality. All the data obtained was stored in a secure password-protected file accessible only to the advisor and the researcher. No information will be shared with any other parties without the participants' written consent.

D. Voluntary Participation - As part of the study, the researchers will ensure that respondents are not forced to participate; respondents' participation will be entirely voluntary. Respondents will be thoroughly informed of their right to withdraw from the research at any time without facing any negative consequences. This assurance aims to create a comfortable and respectful environment, ensuring that respondents from the BUENASCAR, Agusan del Norte teaching non-specialized subjects, feel no obligation to continue if they choose not to. All responses will be collected with respondents' full permission, ensuring they are free to decide and feel safe and comfortable during the study.

E. Minimization of Harm - The study will pose minimal or no physical, emotional, or psychological risk to the participants. The questionnaire items will be designed carefully to avoid discomfort, embarrassment, or professional sensitivity. However, if any participant experiences unease or distress while answering the questionnaire, the researcher will allow the participant to skip sensitive items or withdraw from the study without penalty. If a respondent refuses to answer the questionnaire, the researcher will respect their decision without pressure or consequence. The researcher will politely thank the respondent for their time and ensure that non-participation will not affect their professional standing, relationship with colleagues, or role in the institution. The researcher will cooperate fully in implementing corrective actions, such as revising the data collection process, securing additional consent, or providing referrals for professional or psychological support if necessary. If any respondent shows signs of stress or emotional distress during the data collection, the researcher will immediately pause the session, provide reassurance, and give the respondent time to rest. The researcher will also remind the participant of their right to discontinue participation at any time and, if needed, refer them to appropriate counseling or support services within the institution.

F. Beneficence - The study will aim to provide valuable insights into the challenges and adaptive strategies of teachers teaching non-specialized subjects. The findings will be beneficial to school administrators,

education program developers, and policymakers in developing support mechanisms, professional development programs, and policy interventions that enhance teacher performance and well-being. In addition, the respondents will be given access to a summary of the study's findings after the research is completed. This will allow them to understand the overall results, reflect on their professional experiences, and possibly apply some of the adaptive strategies identified in the study to improve their own teaching practices.

G. Justice and Fair Participant Selection- Respondents will be selected fairly and based on inclusion criteria that ensure diversity in teaching experience, gender, and subject area. No participant will be excluded on the basis of age, gender, race, religion, or other personal background factors. The selection process will promote fairness and equal opportunity for all qualified respondents.

H. Data Integrity and Accuracy - Data collection and analysis will be carried out using standardized procedures to ensure accurate and reliable results. All outputs will be carefully reviewed to reduce errors or biases. The study will also acknowledge limitations, such as sample size or potential biases, to maintain the integrity of the research and comply with all relevant guidelines on participant protection, data privacy, and intellectual property rights. Additionally, all AI-generated content and outputs will be thoroughly reviewed to minimize errors and maintain objectivity, supporting the overall integrity of the research.

I. Transparency in Reporting - The results of this study will be reported accurately and truthfully, without altering or distorting the data. The researcher will acknowledge the importance of transparency and openly disclose any potential conflicts of interest that could affect the study. All third-party materials will be accurately cited to maintain openness and uphold intellectual property rights. This commitment to integrity will safeguard the validity of our research and foster trust in our findings.

J. Use of Patented or Copyrighted Materials - This study will utilize different resources, including copyrighted academic works and secondary data. The researchers recognize the importance of respecting

intellectual property rights and obtaining all necessary permissions before using any copyrighted materials. All resources will be carefully cited in the final report to ensure proper attribution and transparency. This commitment to ethical sourcing will uphold the integrity of the study and acknowledge the contributions of the original author, whose work supports this study.

K. Ethical Considerations for Animal and Human Trials - In this study, all respondents in human trials will receive an informed consent form that clearly explains the study's purpose, procedures, and potential risks and benefits. The informed consent process will emphasize that participation is entirely voluntary, informing respondents of their right to withdraw at any time without consequences. This approach ensures compliance with ethical standards outlined in relevant institutional and international guidelines for human subject research, thereby prioritizing the safety, dignity, and autonomy of all participants.

L. Responsible Use of AI and Related Technologies - The study will incorporate AI tools and digital technologies to assist in various stages of the quantitative research process. ChatGPT will be utilized during the instrument development and preliminary analysis phase to organize ideas, refine questionnaire items, and summarize related literature. Microsoft Excel and SPSS will be used for encoding, organizing, and analyzing the quantitative data. Grammarly will be used to ensure that the research report adheres to proper grammar and clarity standards. The responsible use of these technologies will involve validating AI-assisted outputs, cross-checking statistical results, and ensuring that no AI tools introduce bias or misinterpretation. Participants will be informed about the use of these technologies to ensure full transparency and trust in the research process.

M. Ethical Approval - Ethical approval for the conduct of this study will be obtained from the institutional review board of Saint Michael College of Caraga prior to data gathering, confirming that it adhered to all relevant guidelines on participants protection, data privacy, and intellectual property rights.

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CURRICULUM VITAE



NAME: LEA MAE L. BURDEOS

ADDRESS: P-2, Maningalao Las Nieves Agusan del Norte

EMAIL: leamae_burdeos@smccnasipit.edu.ph

Personal Information

Sex : Female

Date of birth : January 5, 2006

Height : 5’5

Weight : 49

Civil Status : Single

Educational Attainment

Elementary : Maningalao Elementary School

Secondary : Maningalao National High School

Tertiary : Saint Michael College of Caraga

Membership/Affiliations

ORGANIZATION	POSITIONS HELD
Local Student Government	**BTVTED REPRESENTATIVE**

CURRICULUM VITAE



NAME: JOHN PAUL C. CEREZ

ADDRESS: P-7, San Mateo, Mabuhay, Butuan City

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Personal Information

Sex : Male

Date of birth : October 6, 2004

Height : 5’8

Weight : 75

Civil Status : Single

Educational Attainment

Elementary : San Mateo Annex Elementary School

Secondary : Tungao National High School

Tertiary : Saint Michael College of Caraga

Membership/Affiliations

ORGANIZATION	POSITIONS HELD
Michaelinian Performing Arts Guild	**Member**

CURRICULUM VITAE



NAME: RICA C. JAYME

ADDRESS: P-14, Poblacion, Sibagat, Agusan del Sur

EMAIL: rica_jayme@smccnasipit.edu.ph

Personal Information

Sex : Female

Date of birth : March 14, 2001

Height : 5’3

Weight : 60

Civil Status : Single

Educational Attainment

Elementary : Afga Central Elementary School

Secondary : Sibagat National High school of Home Industries

Tertiary : Saint Michael College of Caraga

Membership/Affiliations

ORGANIZATION	POSITIONS HELD

CURRICULUM VITAE



NAME: PRINCE ROBERT T. MIOLE

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EMAIL: princerobert_miole@smccnasipit.edu.ph

Personal Information

Sex : Male

Date of birth : October 21, 2005

Height : 5'3

Weight : 62

Civil Status : Single

Educational Attainment

Elementary : Buenavista Elementary School

Secondary : Buenavista Special Education Integrated School

Tertiary : Saint Michael College of Caraga

Membership/Affiliations

ORGANIZATION	POSITIONS HELD
Michaelinian Performing Arts Guild	**Member**

CURRICULUM VITAE



NAME: JONATHAN C. RABUYA

ADDRESS: P-4, Buenavista, Agusan del Norte

EMAIL: jonathan_rabuya@smccnasipit.edu.ph

Personal Information

Sex : Male

Date of birth : July 04, 2005

Height : 5'11

Weight : 62

Civil Status : Single

Educational Attainment

Elementary : Malapong Elementary School

Secondary : Buenavista National High School

Tertiary : Saint Michael College of Caraga

Membership/Affiliations

ORGANIZATION	POSITIONS HELD

CURRICULUM VITAE



NAME: JORDAN JAMES M. VASQUEZ

ADDRESS: P-4, Buenavista, Agusan del Norte

EMAIL: jordan_vasquez@smccnasipit.edu.ph

Personal Information

Sex : Male

Date of birth : December 21, 2003

Height : 5’5

Weight : 65

Civil Status : Single

Educational Attainment

Elementary : Buenavista Elementary School

Secondary : Saint James High School INC.

Tertiary : Saint Michael College of Caraga

Membership/Affiliations

ORGANIZATION	POSITIONS HELD

Letter of Approval with Certificate of Appearance and Photo

SAINT MICHAEL COLLEGE OF CARAGA
RESEARCH & INSTRUCTIONAL INNOVATION DEPARTMENT
www.smccnasipit.edu.ph

October , 2025

ARLYN A. PINAT
School Principal III
Buenavista National High School

Dear Ma'am Pinat,

Greetings of Peace!

In partial fulfillment of the requirements for the degree, Bachelor of Technical Vocational Teacher Education (BTVTEd) at Saint Michael College of Caraga, we, the third-year students, are currently preparing a thesis proposal entitled: **"Challenges and Adaptation of Teachers Teaching Non-Specialized Subjects."**

In connection with this, we respectfully seek your kind permission to conduct our study at your esteemed institution. As part of the initial stage of our research, we also request a copy of the list of teachers handling non-specialized subjects for the school year 2025–2026. This information will serve as a vital reference in identifying participants for our study. We assure you that the list and any subsequent data will be treated with strict confidentiality and will be used solely for academic purposes. No personal or sensitive information will be disclosed.

Your approval and support in this academic endeavor will greatly aid us in completing our thesis proposal. We look forward to your favorable response to this request.

Thank you very much for your consideration and assistance.

Respectfully yours,

LEA MAE L. BURDEOS
Researcher

Noted by:

RYAN MORADO LAGBAS, LPT
Research Adviser

TO: SIR EDAR
PM - facilitate !

Approved by:

ARLYN A. PINAT
School Principal III

Date:

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SAINT MICHAEL COLLEGE OF CARAGA
RESEARCH & INSTRUCTIONAL INNOVATION DEPARTMENT
www.smccnasipit.edu.ph

October , 2025

MARIA VENUS L. RALLOS
School Principal I
Buenavista Special Education High School
Brgy.3 Buenavista, Agusan Del Norte

Dear Ma'am Rallos,

Greetings of Peace!

In partial fulfillment of the requirements for the degree, Bachelor of Technical Vocational Teacher Education (BTVTEd) at Saint Michael College of Caraga, we, the third-year students, are currently preparing a thesis proposal entitled: **"Challenges and Adaptation of Teachers Teaching Non-Specialized Subjects."**

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Thank you very much for your consideration and assistance.

Respectfully yours,
LEA MAE L. BURDEOS
Researcher

Noted by:
RYAN MORADO LAGBAS, LPT
Research Adviser

Approved by:
MARIA VENUS L. RALLOS
School Principal I

Date: Oct 17, 2025

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SAINT MICHAEL COLLEGE OF CARAGA
RESEARCH & INSTRUCTIONAL INNOVATION DEPARTMENT
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October , 2025

ELENITA S. VERDON, Ph.D.
School Principal IV
Nasipit National Vocational School

Dear Ma'am Verdon,

Greetings of Peace!

In partial fulfillment of the requirements for the degree, Bachelor of Technical Vocational Teacher Education (BTVTEd) at Saint Michael College of Caraga, we, the third-year students, are currently preparing a thesis proposal entitled: **"Challenges and Adaptation of Teachers Teaching Non-Specialized Subjects."**

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Thank you very much for your consideration and assistance.

Respectfully yours,

LEA MAE L. BURDEOS
Researcher

Noted by:

RYAN MORADO LAGBAS, LPT
Research Adviser

Approved by:

ELENITA S. VERDON, Ph.D
School Principal IV

Date: 10/16/2025

Note,
Back on Oct. 21, 2025
@ 1:14 p.m.

SAINT MICHAEL COLLEGE OF CARAGA
RESEARCH & INSTRUCTIONAL INNOVATION DEPARTMENT
www.smccnasipit.edu.ph

October , 2025

LYDIE GWEN G. OÑATE-CAR
Head Teacher I
Culit National High School
D-3 Culit, Nasipit, Agusan del Norte

Dear Ma'am Oñate-car,

Greetings of Peace!

In partial fulfillment of the requirements for the degree, Bachelor of Technical Vocational Teacher Education (BTVTEd) at Saint Michael College of Caraga, we, the third-year students, are currently preparing a thesis proposal entitled: **"Challenges and Adaptation of Teachers Teaching Non-Specialized Subjects."**

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Your approval and support in this academic endeavor will greatly aid us in completing our thesis proposal. We look forward to your favorable response to this request.

Thank you very much for your consideration and assistance.

Respectfully yours,

LEA MAE L. BURDEOS
Researcher

Noted,
Oct. 30, 2025 1:11 pm

Noted by:

RYAN MORADO LAGBAS, LPT
Research Adviser

Approved by:

Record:
Culit NHS
10/30/25

LYDIE GWEN G. OÑATE-CAR
Head Teacher 1

Date:

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EMAIL: RIID@SMCCNASIPIT.EDU.PH

SAINT MICHAEL COLLEGE OF CARAGA
RESEARCH & INSTRUCTIONAL INNOVATION DEPARTMENT

October 2025

JOCELYN B. PACON
School Principal IV
Carmen National High School
Cabatuan, Carmen, Agusan del Norte

Dear Ma'am Pacon,

Greetings of Peace!

In partial fulfillment of the requirements for the degree, Bachelor of Technical Vocational Teacher Education (BTVTEd) at Saint Michael College of Caraga, we, the third-year students, are currently preparing a thesis proposal entitled: **"Challenges and Adaptation of Teachers Teaching Non-Specialized Subjects."**

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Thank you very much for your consideration and assistance.

Respectfully yours,

LEA MAE J. BURDEOS
Researcher

Noted by:

RYAN MORADO LAGBAS, LPT
Research Adviser

Sir Request Approval
Please take charge..

Approved by:

JOCELYN B. PACON
School Principal IV

Date

SAINT MICHAEL COLLEGE OF CARAGA
RESEARCH & INSTRUCTIONAL INNOVATION DEPARTMENT
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October , 2025

MERLITA J. RABINO, MACDDS
School Principal
Our Lady of Carmen Academy of Caraga, Inc.
General Luna St. Poblacion, Carmen, Agusan Del Norte

Dear Ma'am Rabino,

Greetings of Peace!

In partial fulfillment of the requirements for the degree, Bachelor of Technical Vocational Teacher Education (BTVTEd) at Saint Michael College of Caraga, we, the third-year students, are currently preparing a thesis proposal entitled: **"Challenges and Adaptation of Teachers Teaching Non-Specialized Subjects."**

In connection with this, we respectfully seek your kind permission to conduct our study at your esteemed institution. As part of the initial stage of our research, we also request a copy of the list of teachers handling non-specialized subjects for the school year 2025–2026. This information will serve as a vital reference in identifying participants for our study. We assure you that the list and any subsequent data will be treated with strict confidentiality and will be used solely for academic purposes. No personal or sensitive information will be disclosed.

Your approval and support in this academic endeavor will greatly aid us in completing our thesis proposal. We look forward to your favorable response to this request.

Thank you very much for your consideration and assistance.

Respectfully yours,

LEA MAE U. BURDEOS
Researcher

Noted by:

RYAN MORADO LAGBAS, LPT
Research Adviser

Approved by:

MERLITA J. RABINO, MACDDS
School Principal

Date:

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October 2025

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leamae_burdeos@smccnasipit.edu.ph
09816166302

BENJIE SIAO III
Author

Subject: Request for Approval of Research Instrument

Dear Sir Siao III,

In partial fulfillment of the requirements for the degree Bachelor of Technical Vocational Teacher Education (BTVTEd) at Saint Michael College of Caraga, we, third-year students, are currently preparing a thesis proposal entitled: **"Challenges and Adaptation of Teachers Teaching Non-Specialized Subjects."**

In line with this, we would like to respectfully request your approval to use your research instruments for data collection, such as survey questionnaires, interview guides, and others, which we found highly suitable for our study. We intend to use them for gathering data on teachers' experiences and adaptation strategies. We assure you that they will be handled with care and used responsibly.

Your approval and any recommendations you may provide will be highly appreciated to ensure the reliability, validity, and ethical soundness of our data-gathering process. Your support would greatly contribute to the success of our research.

Thank you very much for your time and kind consideration.

Respectfully yours,

LEA MAE L. BURDEOS
Research Leader

Noted by:

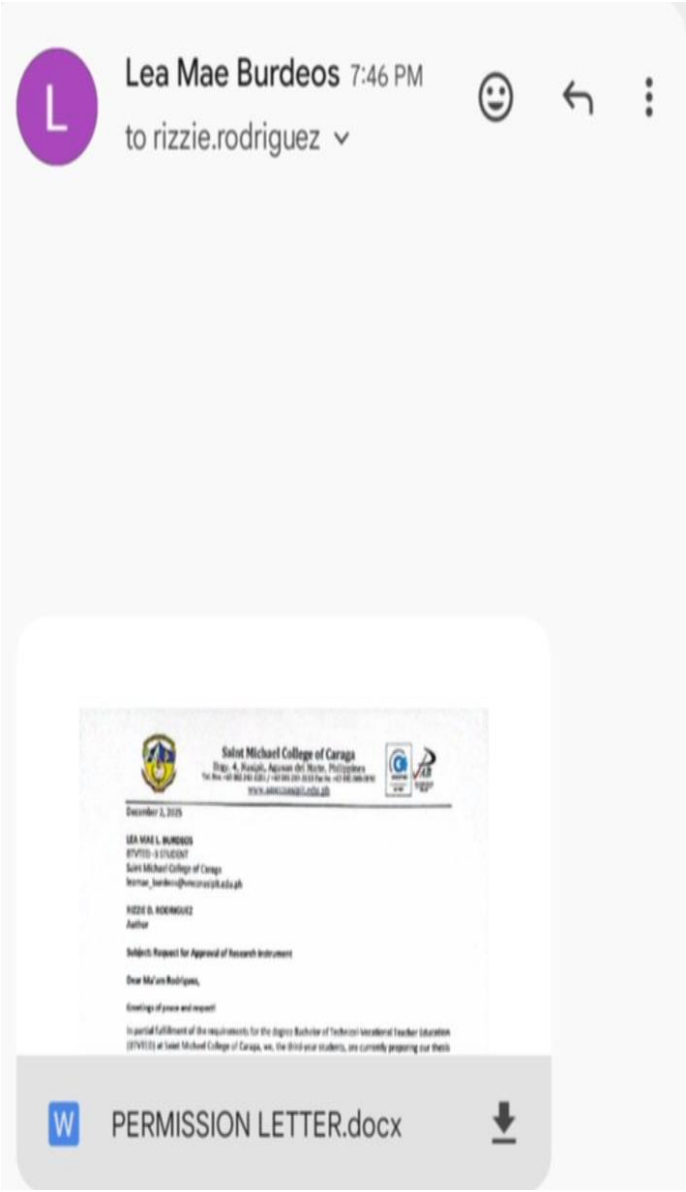
RYAN MORADO LAGBAS, LPT
Research Adviser

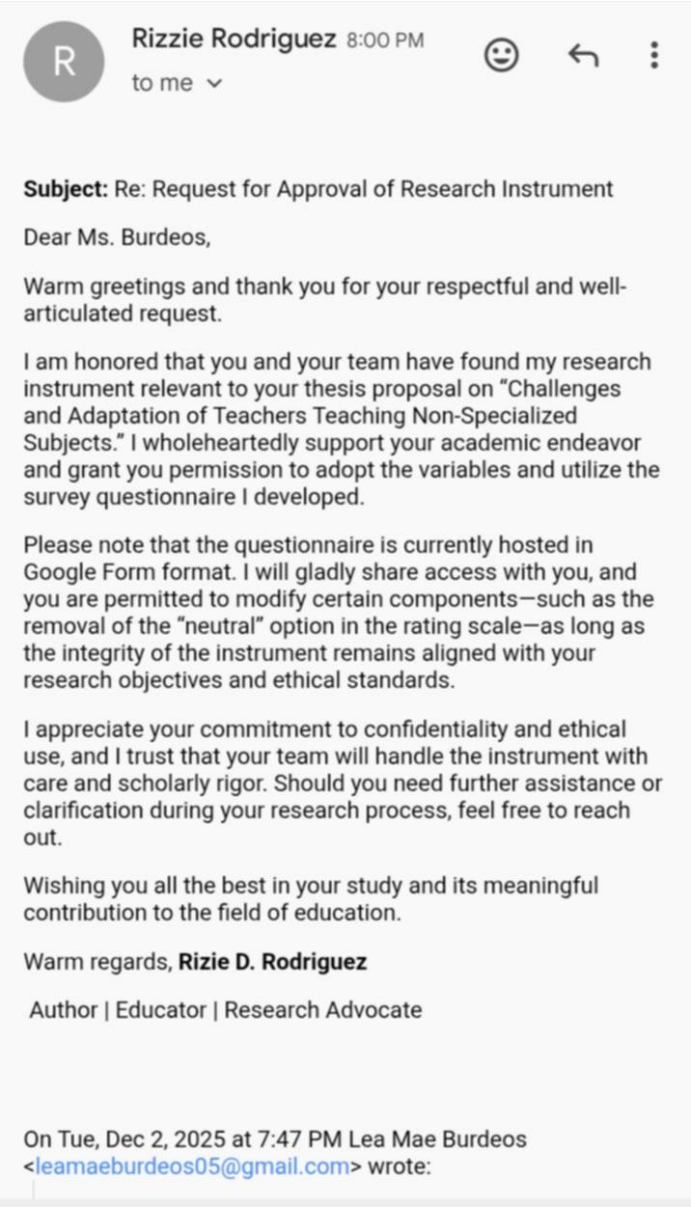
Approved by:

BENJIE SIAO III
Author Date:

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Instrument with Informed Consent





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December 2, 2025

LEA MAE L. BURDEOS
BTVTED -3 STUDENT
Saint Michael College of Caraga
leamae_burdeos@smccnasipit.edu.ph

RIZZIE D. RODRIGUEZ
Author

Subject: Request for Approval of Research Instrument

Dear Ma'am Rodriguez,

Greetings of peace and respect!

In partial fulfillment of the requirements for the degree Bachelor of Technical-Vocational Teacher Education (BTVTED) at Saint Michael College of Caraga, we, the third-year students, are currently preparing our thesis proposal entitled **"Challenges and Adaptation of Teachers Teaching Non-Specialized Subjects."**

We respectfully request your permission to adopt the challenges variables used in your study, as well as your research instrument (survey questionnaire), for application in our research. Your instrument aligns strongly with our research objectives and is highly relevant to the core areas we aim to investigate. To enhance the clarity of participant responses, we likewise seek your approval to modify specific components of the instrument, particularly the removal of the "neutral" option in the rating scale, so as to obtain more explicit and meaningful data.

We assure you that your instrument will be handled with the utmost confidentiality, used exclusively for academic purposes, and administered in strict adherence to established ethical standards. Your approval—along with any recommendations or conditions you may wish to provide—will greatly strengthen the reliability, validity, and methodological soundness of our data-gathering process.

We sincerely appreciate your time, support, and kind consideration. Your contribution will play a significant role in ensuring the quality and success of our research.

Respectfully yours,

LEA MAE L. BURDEOS
Research Leader

Noted by:

RYAN MORADO LAGBAS, LPT
Research Adviser

APPENDIX C-1

Research Survey Questionnaire

"Challenges and Adaptation of Teachers Teaching Non- Specialized Subjects"

General Instructions: Please answer each question honestly. Your responses will be kept strictly confidential and used for research purposes only. There are no right or wrong answers.

Part I: Teachers' Profile

Name (Optional): _____

Directions: Put a (✓) check on the box that corresponds to your answer.

A. Sex:

☐ Male

☐ Female

B. Qualification:

☐ Bachelor's Degree

☐ With Master's Units

☐ Master's Degree Holder

☐ With Doctoral Units

☐ Doctoral Degree Holder

☐ Others: _____

C. Years of Teaching:

☐ 1–5 years

☐ 6–10 years

☐ 11–15 years

☐ 16 years and above

☐ Others: _____

D. Area of Specialization:

☐ Science

☐ English

☐ Filipino

☐ Mathematics

☐ Technology and Livelihood Education (TLE)

☐ Physical Education

☐ Araling Panlipunan

☐ Edukasyon sa Pagpapakatao

☐ Others: _____

E. Subjects Handled Out of Specialization:

- ☐ Science
- ☐ English
- ☐ Filipino
- ☐ Mathematics
- ☐ Technology and Livelihood Education (TLE)
- ☐ Physical Education
- ☐ Araling Panlipunan
- ☐ Edukasyon sa Pagpapakatao
- ☐ Others: _____

F. School Location:

- ☐ Buenavista National High School
- ☐ Buenavista Special Education High School
- ☐ Nasipit National Vocational School
- ☐ Culit National High School
- ☐ Carmen National High School
- ☐ Our Lady of Carmen Academy of Caraga, Inc.

Part II: CHALLENGES (adapted)

DIRECTIONS: For each section, please indicate how much you agree or disagree with the statement by putting a (✓) check on the box on the right side of each statement. There are no right and wrong answers. Your answer will be kept strictly confidential and you will not be identified.

Likert Scale	Description	Interpretation
1	Strongly Disagree (SD)	The statement does not coincide with my experience.
2	Disagree (D)	The statement slightly coincides with my experience.
3	Agree (A)	The statement moderately coincides with my experience.
4	Stongly Agree (SA)	The statement highly coincides with my experience.

I. Challenges

A. Lack of subject knowledge	**Strongly Disagree (1)**	**Disagree (2)**	**Agree (3)**	**Strongly Agree (4)**
1. I struggle to explain complex concepts in a way that my students understand.				
2. I spend a significant amount of extra time learning the material immediately before teaching it.				
3. I feel unprepared to answer student questions related to the subject matter.				
4. My lack of subject-specific knowledge negatively impacts my teaching effectiveness.				
5. I am concerned that my students are not receiving a high-quality education due to my lack of expertise.				
6. I experience anxiety and self-doubt when teaching topics outside my area of expertise.				
B. Classroom management	**Strongly Disagree (1)**	**Disagree (2)**	**Agree (3)**	**Strongly Agree (4)**
1. I struggle to maintain student engagement in subjects outside my area of training.				
2. I find it difficult to adapt my teaching style to effectively manage behavior in unfamiliar subjects.				

3. Students in my out-of-field classes are more likely to exhibit disruptive behavior.				
4. My lack of confidence in the subject makes it harder to address student discipline issues effectively.				
5. I feel less equipped to create engaging and relevant lesson plans, leading to classroom management challenges.				
6. I struggle to build positive relationships with students in subjects where I lack expertise.				
C. Support and Resources	**Strongly Disagree (1)**	**Disagree (2)**	**Agree (3)**	**Strongly Agree (4)**
1. I feel unsupported by the school administration regarding the specific challenges of teaching non-specialized subjects.				
2. Opportunities for collaboration with experienced teachers in teaching non-specialized subject areas are limited.				
3. Professional development programs fail to address the unique needs of teachers teaching non-specialized subjects.				
4. Access to mentorship or guidance from experienced teachers in subjects outside my specialization is insufficient.				
5. The resources provided by the school are inadequate for addressing the unique challenges of teaching non-specialized subjects.				
6. I struggle to find relevant and helpful resources to support my teaching in subjects outside my field.				
D. Psychological Challenges	**Strongly Disagree (1)**	**Disagree (2)**	**Agree (3)**	**Strongly Agree (4)**
1. Teaching subjects outside my specialization makes me feel anxious and uncertain.				
2. I often experience stress when preparing lessons for unfamiliar subjects.				
3. I sometimes doubt my teaching abilities when handling out-of-field topics.				

4. Teaching outside my field causes me to feel emotionally exhausted or burned out.				
5. I feel less motivated when assigned to teach subjects beyond my expertise.				
6. My overall job satisfaction decreases due to the challenges of teaching non-specialized subjects.				

PART III: ADAPTATION (researchers- made)

A. Learning from seasoned teachers	**Strongly Disagree (1)**	**Disagree (2)**	**Agree (3)**	**Strongly Agree (4)**
1. I seek advice from experienced teachers when teaching subjects outside my specialization.				
2. I observe veteran teachers' classes to learn effective teaching techniques.				
3. I apply feedback from senior colleagues to improve my teaching performance.				
4. I feel more confident teaching non-specialized subjects after consulting experienced mentors.				
5. I regularly discuss lesson planning and strategies with seasoned teachers.				
6. Guidance from experienced teachers helps me view teaching non-specialized subjects as a learning opportunity.				
B. Learning from textbooks	**Strongly Disagree (1)**	**Disagree (2)**	**Agree (3)**	**Strongly Agree (4)**
1. I rely on textbooks as my main guide when teaching unfamiliar subjects.				
2. I review textbook lesson sequences to understand the flow of the subject matter.				
3. I use textbook examples and exercises to strengthen my understanding of new content.				

4. Textbooks help me deliver lessons with greater confidence and accuracy.				
5. I find that well-organized textbooks make it easier to teach beyond my specialization.				
6. Using textbooks enhances my subject matter knowledge in out-of-field areas.				
C. Learning from schemes of work	**Strongly Disagree (1)**	**Disagree (2)**	**Agree (3)**	**Strongly Agree (4)**
1. I follow the school's schemes of work to plan lessons in subjects outside my field.				
2. Reviewing schemes of work helps me understand curriculum expectations.				
3. Collaborating with colleagues on schemes of work improves my lesson organization.				
4. Schemes of work guide me in setting clear lesson objectives and pacing.				
5. I use shared lesson frameworks to align my teaching with school standards.				
6. Schemes of work encourage reflective and team-based lesson planning.				
D. Training and Seminars	**Strongly Disagree (1)**	**Disagree (2)**	**Agree (3)**	**Strongly Agree (4)**
1. I attend training programs to enhance my teaching competence in unfamiliar subjects.				
2. Seminars and workshops increase my confidence in handling out-of-field topics.				
3. Training sessions expose me to new and effective teaching methodologies.				
4. I actively apply what I learn from seminars to my classroom practice.				
5. Professional training motivates me to improve my teaching skills continuously.				

6. Participating in training programs enhances my professional growth and morale.				
E. Using Technology to navigate	**Strongly Disagree (1)**	**Disagree (2)**	**Agree (3)**	**Strongly Agree (4)**
1. I use digital platforms to prepare lessons for subjects outside my specialization.				
2. Technology helps me access additional learning materials and resources online.				
3. I incorporate multimedia tools to make lessons more engaging and comprehensible.				
4. Online tutorials and simulations help me understand complex subject topics.				
5. I use educational technology to assess and track students' learning progress.				
6. Integrating technology improves my effectiveness in teaching non-specialized subjects.				

Map of the Research Locale

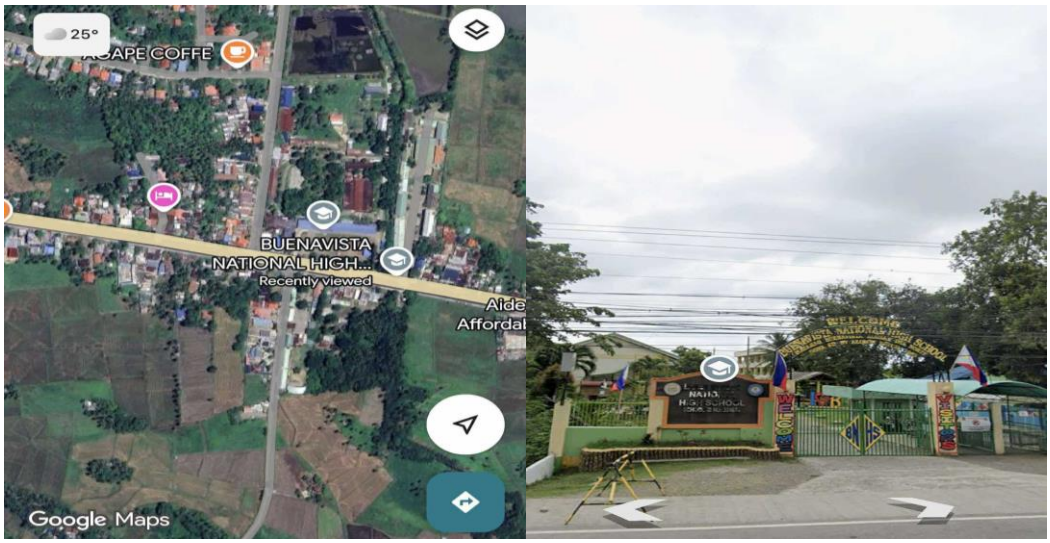


Figure 1: Buenavista National High School

The coordinates for Buenavista National High School are approximately 8.97° North latitude and 125.42° East longitude.

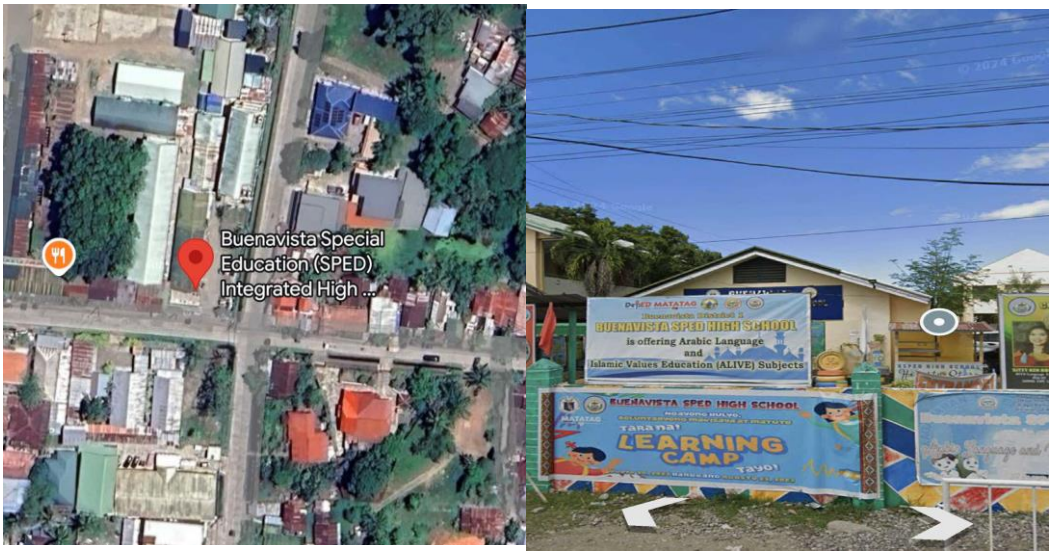


Figure 2 Buenavista Special Education High School

The coordinates for Buenavista Special Education High School are approximately 8.975° North latitude and 125.410° East longitude.

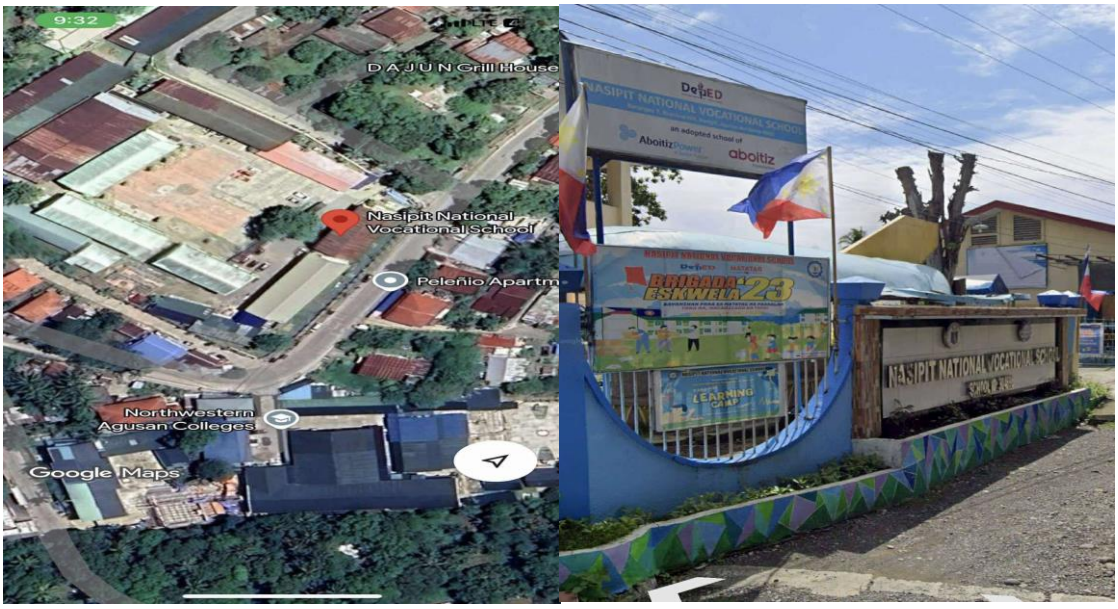


Figure 3 Nasipit National Vocational School

The Nasipit Vocational National High School is located at Bayview Hill, Barangay 7, Nasipit, Agusan del Norte, Philippines. 8°59’N, 125°20’E (or in decimal format: 8.9884, 125.3408).

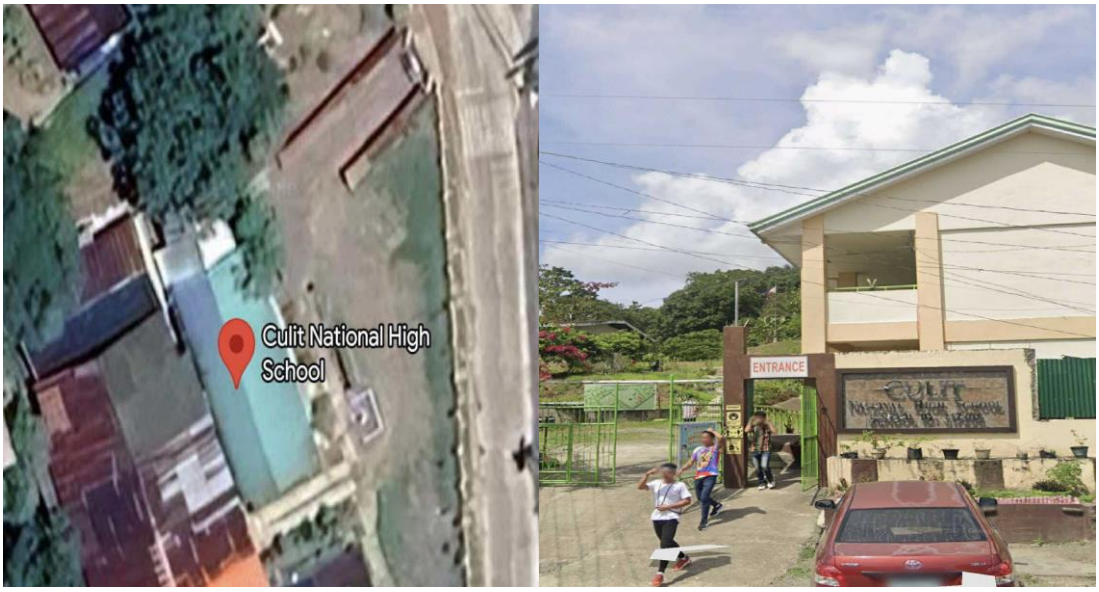


Figure 4 Culit National High School

The coordinates for Culit National High School are approximately 8.94° North latitude and 125.36° East longitude.



Figure 5 Carmen National High School

The coordinates for Carmen National High School are approximately 8.4698° N, 124.6319° E.

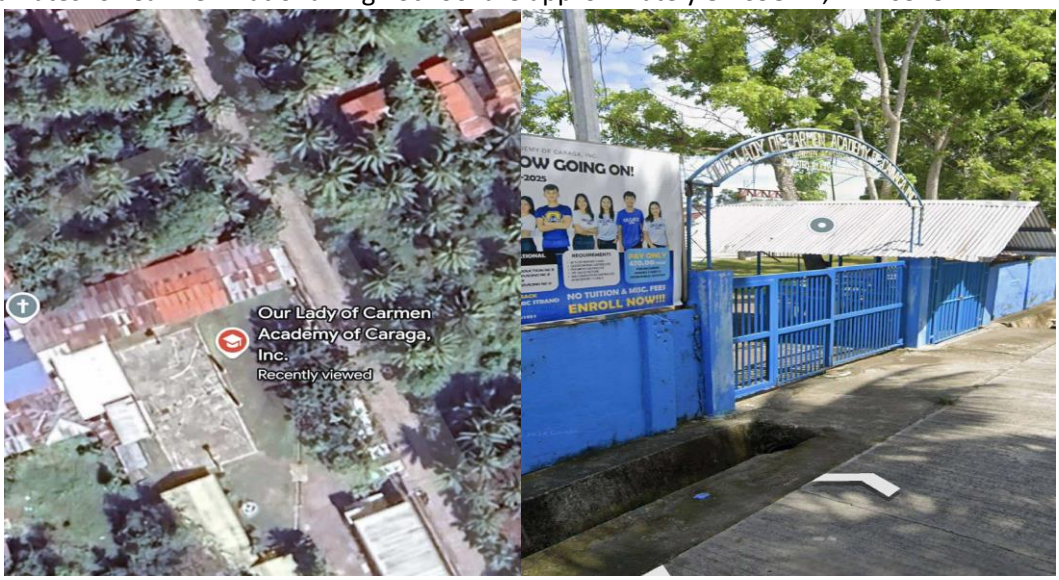


Figure 6 Our Lady of Carmen Academy of Caraga, Inc.

The coordinates for Our Lady of Carmen Academy of Caraga, Inc. are 8.99° North latitude and 125.29° East longitude.

Narrative & Photo Documentation

- Brainstorming for Research Titles.









- Making Chapter 1 and 2.









- Visiting school principal to our respective respondents.





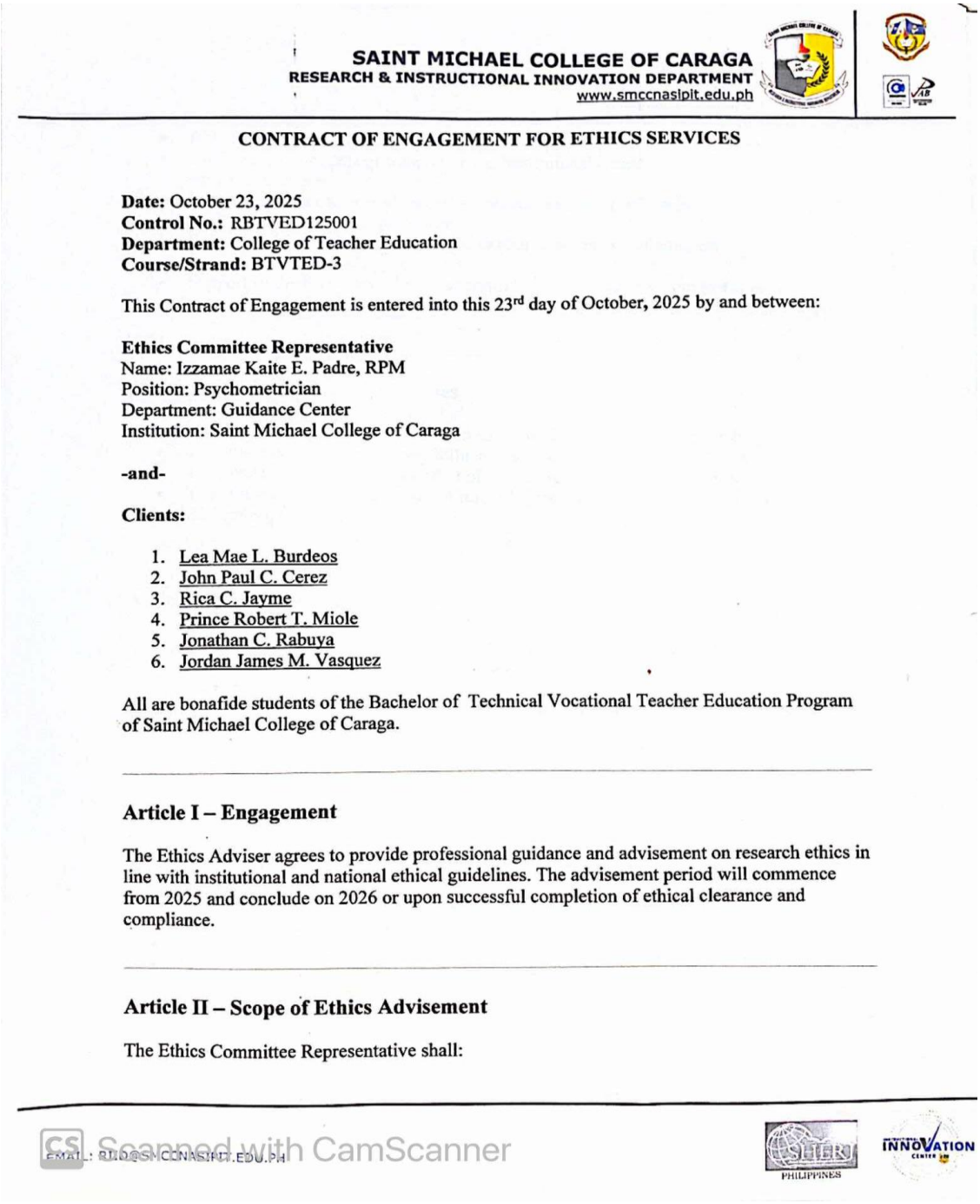


- Preparing for Chapter 1 and 2 proposal.





Ethics Committee Approval



SAINT MICHAEL COLLEGE OF CARAGA
RESEARCH & INSTRUCTIONAL INNOVATION DEPARTMENT
www.smccnasipit.edu.ph

CONTRACT OF ENGAGEMENT FOR ETHICS SERVICES

Date: October 23, 2025
Control No.: RBTVED125001
Department: College of Teacher Education
Course/Strand: BTVTED-3

This Contract of Engagement is entered into this 23rd day of October, 2025 by and between:

Ethics Committee Representative
Name: Izzamae Kaite E. Padre, RPM
Position: Psychometrician
Department: Guidance Center
Institution: Saint Michael College of Caraga

-and-

Clients:

1. Lea Mae L. Burdeos
2. John Paul C. Cerez
3. Rica C. Jayme
4. Prince Robert T. Miole
5. Jonathan C. Rabuya
6. Jordan James M. Vasquez

All are bonafide students of the Bachelor of Technical Vocational Teacher Education Program of Saint Michael College of Caraga.

Article I – Engagement

The Ethics Adviser agrees to provide professional guidance and advisement on research ethics in line with institutional and national ethical guidelines. The advisement period will commence from 2025 and conclude on 2026 or upon successful completion of ethical clearance and compliance.

Article II – Scope of Ethics Advisement

The Ethics Committee Representative shall:

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- Assist advisees/clients in identifying ethical risks and formulating mitigation strategies.
- Guide advisees/clients in completing the Institutional Research Ethics Checklist or similar documents.
- Ensure adherence to ethical research protocols including informed consent, confidentiality, and data protection.
- Review and endorse research ethics compliance forms for submission to the Ethics Review Committee (if applicable).
- Support students in responding to ethics-related clarifications from institutional bodies or external reviewers.

Article III – Ethical Responsibilities

- The Ethics Committee must maintain strict confidentiality of all research details.
- They must not coerce or unduly influence advisees' decisions or methods.
- They must be free from any conflict of interest relating to the research or advisees.
- They must ensure that no unethical research practices, such as plagiarism, falsification, or fabrication, are committed.

Article IV – Authorship & Acknowledgment

- The Ethics Committee Representative **shall not be listed as a co-author** unless a substantial intellectual contribution is made in the conceptualization or methodology of the research.
- Ethics advisement shall be acknowledged in the Acknowledgment section of the manuscript.

Article V – Termination of Engagement

This engagement may be terminated under the following conditions:

- Failure of the Ethics Committee Representative and advisees/clients to fulfill their responsibilities.
- Misconduct or breach of professional ethics.
- Unavailability or lack of communication.
  In such cases, the Research and Instructional Innovation Department will assign a new ethics adviser in consultation with the Dean.

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Article VI – Dispute Resolution

Any disputes arising under this contract shall be referred to the Research and Instructional Innovation Department, with final arbitration by the Office of the Vice President for Academic Affairs and Research.

Signed this 23rd *day of* October, 2025 at Saint Michael College of Caraga, Nasipit, Agusan del Norte, Philippines.

Signatories:
Advisees:

1. Lea Mae L. Burdeos
2. John Paul C. Cerez
3. Rica C. Jarime
4. Prince Robert T. Miole
5. Jonathan G. Taboya
6. Jordan James M. Vasquez

Note: Signature over Printed Name

Ethics Committee Representative:

IZZAMAE KATTE E. PADRE, RPM

Signature Over Printed Name

Witnesses:

1. **MELISA C. MALOLOY-ON, EdD-EM**
2. **THERESA MAE O. BEDAYO, LPT**

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